META-TRANCE

THE ART OF TRANSITIONING TO HIGHER STATES

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Title Page **META-TRANCE**
HYPNOTIC LANGUAGE PATTERNS & PROCESSES

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The material in this training manual is based on the original NLP models in *The Structure of Magic* (1975-6), *Patterns of the Hypnotic Patterns of Milton H. Erickson, M.D.* (1975-6), *Meta-States* (1995/2005), *Secrets of Personal Mastery* (2000), and *Meta-States Training Manual: Accessing Personal Genius* (2001).

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MODELS USED IN THIS TRAINING

NLP—

A Model of Communication about human processing that uses the "languages" of mind (internal cinema of sights, sounds, and sensations, VAK) along with language for "thinking." Via thinking, we frame our understanding of things using the *see, hear, feel* dimensions as well as words. As we *represent* data to ourselves on the inner screen of consciousness, our internal movie signals our bodies about what to experience and feel (we go into state)—a mind-body neuro-linguistic state which governs the quality of our life and experiences. The neuro-linguistic model provides a way to model experiences of excellence by finding the specific step-by-step strategy for generating an experience.

META-STATES® —

A Model of Reflexive Consciousness which extends NLP, taking it to the next level as it details how we *reflect back on* our thoughts and feelings to create *higher levels* of our thinking and feeling. This layering of our thinking and feeling states create *states-**about**-states* or meta-states. Primary emotions (e.g., fear, anger, joy, relaxed, tense, pleasure, pain, etc.) give us *primary states* in which thoughts are directed outward. In *meta-states* higher level thinking gives us concepts, understandings, beliefs, etc. The *Meta-States* Model describes higher frames-of-mind that give us more stable structures that define our belief systems, values, identities, etc. It is the *inner game* that governs the outer games.

NEURO-SEMANTICS® —

Neuro-Semantics refers to a simple fact— you create *meanings* (semantics) in your mind and you then translate those meanings into actions or performances that you experience in your body (neurology). When something *means* something to you—you *feel* it in your body. The meanings become your emotions. The *Neuro-Semantics* Model reveals *how humans make meaning* in evaluating experiences. Then those constructed meanings defines the world that you live in. It describes the frames of meaning you use as you move through life. It creates a matrix of frames in which you live that defines your lived world. Coming from the *Meta-States model*, Neuro-Semantics has been prolific in generating more than a dozen new models and hundreds of new patterns and processes.

"META"

(above, about, beyond)

The Power to Rise Above

META-TRANCE
Synopsis

Introduction to Trance and Meta-Trance
- What is "Trance?"
  - Kinds of Trances
  - The Meaning and Feeling of "Hypnosis"
  - The Nature of Hypnotic Dynamics
  - The Language of Hypnosis
  - Using the Meta-Model and the Milton Model for Trance Inductions
    - Using the Meta-Model Hypnotically
    - Meta-Model Logical Levels: Up into Abstractions
    - Patterns of Hypnotic Language: The Milton Model
    - Hypnotic Relations

Meta-States as Trance States
- "Trance" in Neuro-Semantics
  - The Direction of Trance as "Up"
- Meta-States as Trance Phenomenon
- Transitioning from Primary to Meta-States
- The Linguistics of Meta-Levels
  - Meta-Stating Questions and Statements

Genius Inductions
- The Genius Pattern
- Exercises
  - Genius Inductions

Articles
- The Hypnotic Nature and Language of Meta-States

Training Design:

1) Trance as an Inward & Upward Focus
   - Nature of Trance
   - Feeling of Trance
   - Language of Trance
   - Direction of Trance

2) Linguistics of Trance
   - Meta-Model
   - Milton Model
   - Meta-States: language of

3) Texturing States with States
   - Meta-Blessings to loosen the tongue
   - Meta-Resources to set the pen free

4) The Genius State as a Trance State
   - Model: Structure
   - Inductions
   - Design engineering new genius states

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

While *trance* and *hypnosis* and *hypnotic language* may sound mysterious and strange and very psychological— these words refer to a very common everyday experience. They refer to how you think and experience the world— you *go inside* as it were and play a movie in your mind of things you remember, things you imagine, things you hope for, dread, want, and care about. They refer to the inner game that you play in your mind as you prepare yourself for an upcoming event and how you go into a mental and emotional state in preparation.

You experience trance when you drive on a highway for many hours— the highway trance. You experience trance when you step in an elevator and wait until it arrives at your floor—the elevator trance. You experience it when you hear an engaging story. When you listen to the radio. And those trances can be empowering as when an athlete imagines the event to prepare himself for it or an actress imagines the lines she's about to say. They can also be dis-empowering as when our imaginations generate worries, anxieties, dreads, etc.

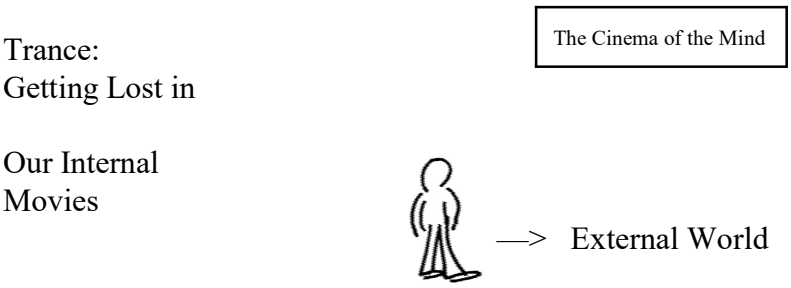
The special kind of language patterns that you use to put yourself into various states is known as hypnotic language patterns— a storyteller uses them to paint word pictures that induce you into a real or imagined story so that you feel it and may feel it so much that it becomes one of your referent experiences. The storyteller uses very specific images, sights, sounds, and sensations to take you on an imagined journey. Or it can be a speaker who uses vague and abstract words that require you to fill in the blanks and as you do, you see and hear and feel with your referents and find or create meaning from those words. This is the art of specifically using vague words to induce an experience that you make up.

Either way, the trance induction takes you somewhere and gives you an experience. Learning to do that is part and parcel of every professional communicator as well as the ability to distinguish the levels of communication— being specifically precise and being vaguely precise. One set of communications takes you inside, the other takes you outside. One builds up movies and constructs that makes the inner world richer and fuller. The other implements action and performance in the outer world to successfully reach desired outcomes.

Welcome to the world of communication and specifically to the world of inducing resourceful trance states! In the end you will learn how to create great inductions for yourself and others, exposes old trance inductions that have created harmful post-hypnotic suggestions that have undermined your effectiveness, and detect inductions so that you have choice about which ones to go with and which ones to refuse.

META-TRANCE:
The Structure of State Induction
— Collaborative State Induction

Figure 1
The Hypnotic State



WHAT IS HYPNOSIS ANYWAY?

1) Hypnosis or trance is an altering of one's state.

In hypnosis, we turn inward and access meanings, memories, imaginations, understandings, etc. We develop an inward focus of attention. We facilitate this using non-referencing words and non-referring noun phrases. Such words invite and elicit us to go inside one's mind, to one's internal worlds of meaning.

> "I want you to find yourself getting really comfortable as you sit in that chair and to allow yourself to recall a time and a place where you were thoroughly and completely relaxed as you wonder about how valuable accessing your own personal genius will be ... at work, in your career, at home ..."

2) Hypnosis or trance is Communication.

Hypnosis is simply communicating, saying words, swishing a brain to a new and different referent and inducing a state. Whether that state is an enhancing state or one that causes them to "freak cookies" is an entirely different matter.

> "Hypnosis is fundamentally no different than any effective communication. There is no such thing as hypnosis as a separate and distinct process." (Bandler and Grinder, *Trance-Formations,* 1979, p. 2)

3) Hypnosis or trance is a highly focused state of awareness.

Trance is a state of deep and intense concentration. In this mind-body phenomenon, you can get so much into a trance-like state that it's as if you are no longer here, but somewhere else. These states occur naturally, as when you become engrossed in a task, captivated by a "spell"

binding speaker, lost in a movie or television program, etc. So anything that captures your attention, enthralls your heart and casts a spell as when you hear a captivating story is hypnosis. Whenever you turn inward and to access an internal world of images, sounds, sensations, etc., you have *transitioned* (hence, *trance)* from the outside state to an internal one.

4) Hypnosis or trance is a change of orientation.

Trance involves "a different type of reality orientation." In trance you are no longer oriented toward external reality, but oriented inwardly to subjective reality.

5) Trance is working with ideas which are typically outside of cognitive conscious awareness.

We work with the part of the mind we call the "*unconscious"* mind. This allows us to maximize the receptivity and potentials of the body and nervous system for learning, pain control, skill development, etc.

6) Trance is an intense absorption.

To an outside observer, trance can appear as if the person is asleep. Inwardly, however, you experience trance as a heightened state of self-control, focus, and power. The loss of orientation to the outside world and that "funny feeling" of disorientation is matched with that inner concentration and vitality.

7) Trance is a state of suggestibility.

Trance is an "state of autonomous responsiveness to suggestion without any conscious understanding." (Erickson, *Healing in Hypnosis,* Vol. I, 10). Trance awareness is characterized by an intense receptiveness to ideas (p. 8). As a special relationship between two persons, trance occurs when one person allows another to express ideas and suggestions while in a receptive and cooperative state.

So in trance or hypnosis — we are working with *ideas* in a highly focused and engaged way. We are *communicating* to offer suggestions to ourselves or others that will alter our orientation and performances in the world.

THE NATURE OF HYPNOTIC DYNAMICS

1) *Trance is an everyday phenomenon.*

Hypnosis is a natural process that occurs everyday to everybody. As a basic human mechanism, everybody goes into hypnosis and do so constantly. Whenever you are not immediately present in external sensory awareness, you are in a trance state. Deep thinking, concentrating, praying, meditating, etc. are commonly occurring hypnotic states. That you seldom notice these naturally occurring hypnotic states doesn't make them any less hypnotic. That you do not know how to use them systemically to induce preferred altered states that enhance your life doesn't make them any less trance.

2) Trance is an amplifier of experience.

As a state of consciousness that amplifies experience, trance offers a very powerful tool for running your own brain. You can use trance to get more intense responses from yourself and others. This exposes one of the central myths about hypnosis. In hypnotizing you are never controlling another person's brain. You are rather *working with them* to amplify the other's states. As an amplifier of your powers and skills, trance can intense your states of energy, numbness (pain control), alteration of time (time speeding, time going really slow), the potentials of your nervous system, etc. Yet for all that, it is not a panacea and you cannot do everything with it.

A person can always resist inductions, refuse suggestions, break state, and not allow his or her responses to amplify. *Hypnosis can't* ***make*** *you or anyone else do anything that you don't want to do!* In trance work, you only provide stimuli that allows another to respond if they choose to cooperate. Resistance and cooperation are but demonstrations of the ability to respond and especially, notice what people respond to naturally.

3) Trance is a bio-feedback mechanism.

As a relational dynamic, you hypnotize by using yourself as a bio-feedback mechanism to the other person. Rather than having no control, being *in trance* means having much more control over ourselves. Hypnosis gives you more control in running your brain, states, and neurology. It does this by providing feedback that typically you do not have (*Patterns,* p. 13). In traditional hypnosis, people have long talked about how *"deep"* one goes into trance. The originators of NLP did not find "depth" as a meaningful way to think about trance. Trance is only taking conscious experience and altering it so one focuses on something else. "Positive hallucinations" all the time, only we call it "thinking." Engineers go out to fields and hallucinate freeways and dams and then they measure them. Seeing a freeway where there isn't one is called "work," and is considered a natural and useful way of hallucinating.

4) Trance is a set of tools.

As a form of communication, hypnosis enables you to alter your thoughts, change your frames, and to swish our brains to new references.

> "Hypnosis is a process of distraction, fixation, and generalization. It's fixating a person on ideas that evoke wonder and questioning and then utilizing the need for answers." (Erickson, *Healing in Hypnosis,* II)

KINDS OF TRANCES

"If trance is an altered state on the continuum of awareness, should there not then be the possibility of *different states of trance?* Since theorists generally accept multiple states of awareness, why is trance designated as only one of those states, when it can represent a number of degrees on the scale of awareness? I propose that the term *trance* can be used to characterize a subset of *states* along that continuum of altered states of awareness and that the differences in these states may be accounted for by differences in the motivation of the subject." (Develop Ericksonian Therapy, Chapter 9 by Kay F. Thompson, p. 153).

"When we examine the concept of the purpose of trance, we realize that there are numerous

possibilities. There are trances that have a hidden agenda, those that defend from other trances, trances for relaxation, trances for fun, trances for exploration, for physiological uses, for habit control, and so on. ... The basic difference I see is motivation."

"Examining trances from the point of view of the client's motivation leads to a proposal of six distinct types of trance:

1. Clinical, chief motivation: self-control or self-help
2. Experimental, motivation: money, mankind, learning
3. Demonstration, motivation: learning, or teaching
4. Entertainment, motivation: to entertain
5. Forensic, motivation: recall past events
6. Spontaneous, motivation: self-control, self-help."

Strictly speaking, an *altered state* is any shift in consciousness away from an ordinary, baseline state. If your waking state is the baseline, then sleep, dreams, drunkenness, meditative absorption are a few of the many altered states you regularly enter and experience. Within your normal range of consciousness, you have innumerable discrete states: fatigue, excitement, sexual arousal, anxiety, rage, fear, etc. Each of these are a discrete state, each unique as an experience and as a pattern of brain arousal. These are within the normal ranges. When a shift overleaps these limits, it becomes an altered state. The *normal waking state* refers to one in which you can report accurately what happens in your environment and can use this information to control your behavior. This as an *uptime state.* When in an altered state, you generally are not able to so effectively orient ourselves to the reality of the outside world (sleep, drugged, delirious, etc.).

THE FEELING OF TRANCE

What is it like? What does it feel like?

Figure 2
The Feeling of Trance

Feelings that lead to Trance

Relaxed
Passive Experiencing
Sense of Control/ Mastery
Entranced with an Idea
Meaning, Imaginative
Hope, Dream, Fear, Desire

Relaxed
Calm, Stillness
Confusion
Overwhelmed
Bored
Repetition, Habituation

THE LANGUAGE OF HYPNOSIS

At its heart, hypnosis involves *communicating ideas* to a mind in such a way that it powerfully affects one's entire being—one's neuro-linguistic experience or reality. This communication involves words and gestures. It involves *what* we say and *how* we say it.

Using the Meta-Model for Trance

Before Bandler and Grinder (1975) modeled Milton Erickson's expertise in hypnosis, they identified many of the linguistic patterns of therapeutic expertise in Perls and Satir. From this they created the *Meta-Model* of language that detailed "the structure of magic." This model consists of eleven (or twelve) *linguistic distinctions* that enable you to identify *vagueness* in the use of language. Later they realized that this is what "hypnotizes." The linguistic vagueness forces people to make sense of things from their own internal references. So hypnosis is the art of using vague language precisely.

As you use the Meta-Model to identify the vagueness of expressions, it enables you to thereby question the vagueness. The Meta-Model highlights the presence of *unspecified nouns, verbs, references, nominalizations,* etc. to point out the language that hypnotizes. This is the language that forces a person to *go inside* to construct meanings (the language of hypnosis).

When you use the Meta-Model for hypnosis, you use ill-formed language that evokes a person to engage in filling in the missing pieces from her or her own personal history or imagination. In this, the Meta-Model identifies natural trance states that we create unknowingly by our use of *language.*

De-Hypnotizing: If the Meta-Model identifies the form and structure of trance, its genius also consists in its questions. By questioning language, the Meta-Model *brings us out of trance.* This means that when we know *how* language works its "magic" to entrance, we are given the secrets for how to break negative hypnotic trances that undermine our resourcefulness. The *questioning challenges* de-hypnotizes us as it calls us into *Uptime*.

You can now use the Meta-Model in two ways:

- **1) To De-Hypnotize.** Use the meta-modeling questions to *reduce* the complexity and vagueness of expressions in language, to pull apart linguistic constructions, and to de-frame. Using the Meta-Model in this way slays and tames *"dragons"* states. It works as de-hypnotizing to bring us out of negative trances.

- **2) To Hypnotize.** Use the meta-modeling questions to create constructive trances because language can move a person *up* the scale of abstraction to map better conceptual realities. Moving *up* enables you to build new generalizations—what we call beliefs, understandings, paradigms, etc. When you so use the Meta-Model, you meta-state yourself and others by setting up new and more powerful frames. As you create internal frames— you enter into a framed reality, that is, a hypnotic state.

USING THE META-MODEL HYPNOTICALLY

The following Meta-Model distinctions can not only be used to question or challenge vague expressions, you can use them to invite and facilitate trance.

1. Deletions/ Simple & Comparative.

"I know you are curious... and your curiosity can increase as you wonder..."

The object of that sentence is completely missing.

"And it's more or less the right thing..."

That is an unspecified comparison. A comparison is made, yet it's not specified as to what or whom it was made— the listener has to supply his or her own meanings.

2. Lack of Referential Index.

Phrases that do not pick out a specific portion of the listener's experience.

"One can, you know, learn more when in a deeper state of relaxation, since people have the ability to relax, and you also can notice a certain sensation even now..."

3. Unspecified Verbs.

Menu list: Do, fix, solve, move, change, wonder, think, sense, know, experience, understand, remember, become aware of, etc. because such words are relatively unspecified, they allow the listener to supply the meaning.

4. Nominalizations.

"Provide you with new insights and understandings..."

The words sound like nouns but are process words which have been frozen in time.

"We all have potentials we're unaware of and we usually don't know how they'll be expressed."

Favorite hypnotic inductions arise from such terms as curiosity, hypnosis, learnings, and love. These nominalizations are effective for hypnotic inductions because they require the listener to search for appropriate meaning.

5. Lost Performative.

"And it's a good thing to wonder..."

This value judgment is asserted without specifying who made the value judgment.

"It's good that you can relax so easily."

6. Universal Quantifiers.

Words that make universal generalizations containing no specific referential index.

"And now you can go all the way into a trance, deeper than you've ever gone before."

7. Modal Operators.

"You *can* learn, really learn..."

Words which form our Rules in life and create our *modus operandi* (style of operation) involve words indicating such things as possibility, necessity, desire, choice, etc.

8. Mind-Reading.

Claiming to know the thoughts or feelings of the listener without specifying the process for obtaining the information. In Mind-Reading we assume knowledge of another's internal experience and as a hypnotic language pattern, this can build credibility.

"I know that you are worrying due to this uncertainty about what will happen and ..."

9. Cause-Effect.

Linkage words like "because, make, force, cause, and, etc." imply a cause-effect relationship between something that's occurring and something we want to occur. It invites a listener to respond as if one thing causes another.

Implied Causatives include: "If...then, as you... then you, and, during, while, as, when, makes, causes, forces, requires," etc.

"As you sit there smiling, you can begin to relax even more." "While you sway back and forth, you can feel more comfortable than before." "The nodding of your head will make you relax more completely."

10. Complex Equivalence.

Equating two external behaviors or events and treating them as if the same or equivalent creates this linguistic distinction.

"As you feel that warm feeling spread you can realize how deeply you are beginning to relax..."

11. Presuppositions.

Linguistic assumptions give us a powerful language pattern since we can presuppose the ideas and frames that we want another to operate from without question.

"You are learning many things..."

"I don't want you to go into a trance until you fully realize that it will increase your capacities so that you can more fully develop your potentials..."

Exercise #1:

Write an induction for a desired state using the Meta-Model Distinctions.

Example:

When you consider becoming more effective as a human being in all of the experiences of your life— in your relationships, your health, your career, your finances, and the list could go on and on, it s a delightful curiosity because it enables you to actually start to create more effectiveness by how your imagination activates your neurology preparing you to actualize your dreams and doing so in a way that uniquely fits for you because as you become the architect of your life-dreams, your unconscious mind knows precisely what you really want and need and so even when you search for resources with which to be more effective, your unconscious mind is already at work, beyond your awareness, accessing those resources and you can relax into the joy that it is happening right now and one of the signs of that is your curiosity.

PATTERNS OF HYPNOTIC LANGUAGE
The Milton Model

The following linguistic distinctions are those of the Milton Model that supplement the inverse Meta-Model.

1) Negation

The *command* negation gives you a simple and direct hypnotic pattern. "Don't think of a blue elephant." Some negations work (see the book, *Sub-Modalities Going Meta*), but the command negation forces us to represent the very thing we're invited to *not* think about.

"I don't want you to relax, too soon or too deeply."

"I wouldn't want you to realize too quickly that learning such language patterns are going to come easier than you ever suspected, because if you did might be as surprised as I think you'll find yourself becoming..." "You don't have to think about relaxing too comfortably..." "People can sleep and not know they're asleep. They can dream and not remember the dream. You don't know when the eyelids will close all by themselves."

"I wouldn't tell you to be eager to discover how you'll change comfortably in the coming weeks as you learn to run your brain more effectively."

Due to the effect of this kind of negation, teach yourself to explicitly phrase things in the positive when inducing a trance. Focus on giving positive commands. Negation exists only in the mind and not at the level of sensory experience.

2) Tag Questions

A tag question is simply a negation in the form of a question added on at the end of a sentence that invites a representation. Adding a question after a statement (like "can you not?") tends to displace resistance. Tag questions are negations or reversals at the end of a sentence.

"You are beginning to relax, are you not?"

"That makes sense, doesn't it?"

"And you can make those changes that will benefit you most, can you not?"

"As you sense that relaxation spreading, you can let it continue, can you not?"

"You do understand tag questions, don't you?" "You're feeling alert, aren't you?"

Caveat: Be careful in using this. Because it has been over-used in some contexts, a great many people can now hear this pattern and when they do, they recognize it as a form of manipulation. The tag question is emphasized. Express it as an aside— as an after-thought.

3) Transition Linkages Using and/or Implying Cause-Effect

When you get rapport, gracefully guide the person from present state to the trance state. Transitional words (and, as, when, inasmuch, because, since, while, before, after, during, etc.) allow you to do this smoothly since these words imply that there is some meaningful

relationship between the two utterances.

> *"As* you sit there, it's possible for you to realize that I'm about to tell you something. ... You can feel the texture of your moustache and as you slide your finger, you can notice that you smiled and stopped. You can even feel your elbow with your other hand and sense the rise and fall of your own chest as you breath. And you may not know it yet, but you're about to become aware of the temperature of your right foot" (p. 17).

Using transitional words builds relationships between parts of sentences and to time which then allows the person to move from one idea to another without disjunction. Ideas then become more related simply by adding those connecting words. This allows you to take ideas that don't naturally fit together and fit them together gracefully. The connectors sound meaningful.

There are three kinds of transitional linkages. 1) The simplest is: *"X and Y."* 2) A little stronger is: *"As X, Y."*

> "As you listen to the sound of my voice, you will become more comfortable." "When I reach over and touch you on the knee, you will have a sense of dropping into an even more relaxed state." "While..."

3) The strongest is: *"X causes Y."*

> "The lifting of your hand makes you drift off into a pleasant memory." Build upon things they can verify.
> "You can feel the pain in your arm, and it hurts very badly, but you can also feel the beating of your heart, the movement of your toes, and you can feel the sound in your ears as your heart beats. You can feel your glasses on your nose, and it's possible for you to begin to feel that other hand, and that other hand can become very intense in its feelings. You can notice each finger, and in fact, you can take all the feelings in one hand and put them in another."

Transitions gracefully provide a way for moving from one idea to another. If I want to know if you consciously understand that I'll make a smooth transition. This works because it's natural to respond to things that fit together. By contrast, *disjointed* communication offers a powerful tool for an opposite outcome. Un-natural transitions elicit responses that interrupt consciousness.

> "I wish my wife would leave me alone." "Lock her in a closet."

Conjunctions are ways of linking experiences and so anchoring a connection between things. Linkages don't have to be logical. They only need to match an ongoing experience and lead to another.

> "You can sit right there and keep right on looking at me and yet sensing an ever-increasing sense of curiosity, because even though you can sometimes seem confused about things, you can continue to learn unconsciously, knowing that your unconscious mind knows much more and can work from that greater knowledge..."
> *"Since* you are here, you can easily learn in new and different ways that will surprise you..."
> *"As* people learn these patterns, they think of creative ways to use them and the people they want to use them on."
> "Learning these language patterns will make it possible for you to pace anybody's ongoing

experience so that you can more effectively establish rapport which will give you more power to influence them.

3) Nominalizations and non-referencing noun phrases

Use these language forms to easily and unconsciously evoke a person to create the new resoruceful experiences. Use meaningful sights, sounds, sensations and smells. Use multi-ordinal words like: "security, contentment, ease, peace, serenity, calmness, effectiveness, learnings, growing sense of inner acceptance," etc.

"And you may already have noticed that the more you take this inner journey, the more insights and understandings that will make your life more effective and productive arise to your consciousness or may just generate a sense of confidence and ease within you."

4) Double binds

Use Either-Or questions that create pseudo- double-binds.

"Would you like to enter a trance now or later?"

"And that means that your unconscious mind is also here, and can here (phonological ambiguity) what I can say. And since that's the case, you are probably learning about this, and already know more at an unconscious level than you think you do, and it's not right for me to tell him, learn this or learn that, let him learn in any way he wants that is effective and useful for him, and in whatever order."

"Soon you will find a finger or a thumb moving a bit, perhaps by itself. It can move up or down, to the side or press down. It can be slow or quick, or perhaps not move at all. The really important thing is to sense fully whatever feelings develop so as to develop this capacity of self-awareness."

5) Ambiguities

Ambiguity offers an important tool for creating mild confusion and disorientation that's useful in inducing altered states. Any ambiguity makes it possible for the listener to internally process a message in more than one way.

Phonological ambiguity involve words that sound alike:

"Hear/ here; right/ write/ rite; I /eye; insecurity/ in security/ red/ read; there/their/ they're; weight/ wait; nose/ knows."

Syntactic ambiguity: The syntax isn't clear.

"They are visiting relatives." "Speaking to you as a child..." "The old men and women..." "The disturbing noises and thoughts, the weight of your hands and feet." "Hypnotizing hypnotists can be tricky."

Scope ambiguity: when you can't determine a linguistic context for how much is applied to that sentence by some portion of the sentence.

"We'll go with the charming men and women."

Punctuation ambiguity:

"I want you to notice your hand me the glass." "How are you able to go into a deep trance?" "That's right now you've already begun to relax."

6) Conversational Postulates

A Yes / No question that elicits a behavioral response.

"Do you feel this ... (punctuation ambiguity) is something that you understand?"
"Can you tell me what you feel?" "Would you speak softer?"

7) Quotes

"Last week I was with Bob who told me about his training last week in Denver when he talked to a friend who said, 'You ought to be willing to feel more comfortable...'"
"I have a friend who's so creative that he has learned how to *enjoy learning new things* in a way that fun though academic. Can you imagine that?"

You can talk to someone about a client of Milton Erickson's who wanted to really learn about hypnosis. He listened to Erickson talk about hypnosis and thought he understood. Then Erickson turned to him and said emphatically,

"You really don't know something until you've practiced every piece of it thoroughly!"

8) Selectional Restriction Violation

Any language that violates a restriction from the meaning of the words. Since only sentient beings (humans and animals) are capable of having feelings, this sentence violates that condition:

"And the old chair feels unappreciated sitting out there all alone ..."

9) Truisms

"Sooner or later, your eyes are going to close and you can allow them to close no faster than you can sense the relaxing feelings that brings."
"Your headache can now leave as soon as your neurological system is ready for it to leave."

10) Multi-Level Communications

By using rich metaphors we can speak on several different levels simultaneously and thereby layer in many other hypnotic patterns.

11) Organ Language

This naturally occurring feature of language shows up in how we talk about a person or event as being "a pain in the neck."

"It will be so handy to put your finger on precisely the most useful aspect of that experience."

12) Metaphors

Non-propositional language including stories, analogies, metaphors, etc. A metaphor literally "brings over to" (phorein) to (meta) your thinking something that you already know as a comparison so that you can understand something new that you do not understand or so that you can understand it in a different way. It is a comparison. Typically it is a concrete and/or actual referent that allows me to think about or frame something else in terms of that known

referent. In a metaphor, you apply to and bring to the known to the unknown.

With regard to metaphors, you can find them in words and phrases:

1) Single words can contain a metaphor: dragon, dance, wall, etc.
2) Words that are suggestive of other ideas: in (containers), after (space), etc.
3) Sentences and/or stories that are encase in a larger level metaphor or story.
4) Isomorphic metaphors where nearly every aspect of the metaphors relates to an aspect of an experience.

DELIVERING HYPNOTIC LANGUAGE

There are special ways to speak hypnotic language that differs from speaking non-propositional language for precision and specificity.

13) Analogue Marking for Embedding Commands and Questions

Analogue marking means marking out certain words non-verbally in your talk. You can mark out words as separate messages with your tone, gesture, expression or touch. You can use a certain tone of voice to associate it with relaxation, trance, comfort, etc. Analogue marking isn't a new thing, we all already do it. Listen carefully to people and notice what they mark out. You can set statements off by tone, pause, or volume and so interspersed them in the middle of a conversation to bypass cognitive awareness.

> "And I want you to tell me only the things *you want to tell me everything*. You can describe it as *freely* as you want..."

Embedded commands gives you a way to deliver double-messages, one to the cognitive conscious mind and the other to the cognitive unconscious. By analog markings (shifts in tonality, visual cues, location shifts, etc.) you can mark out a part of the message to be processed unconsciously.

Embedded Questions similarly provide a way to put a question into a sentence that's structured as a statement.

> "I'm wondering if you can *tell me what you want*."
> "I'm curious if you can *learn differently*."
> "I keep asking myself if you can *practice these patterns* throughout the coming week unconsciously while you *have fun* doing other things."

14) Incorporation

When anything happens—immediately incorporate it. You can incorporate it metaphorically so that the buzz of conversation becomes "the buzz of bees on a warm summer day picnic..." Take whatever happens and give it whatever meaning you want to give it.

> "And that loud slam of the door you hear will allow you to be even more comfortable as you sit here listening to my voice..." (p. 91)

Respond to abreactions in this way. Sometimes people experience intense unpleasant

responses when they go into a trance. As they alter their state to one that may have massive amounts of unpleasant experience stored in it, they may feel some old pain again. If the person suddenly bursts into tears— incorporate it as feedback and validate the experience. This will tend to eliminate any fight about it.

> "See yourself at the age of those tears and with a sense of curiosity, realizing with a sense of comfort that you survived it... "

Put it in an outcome frame and use it constructively.

> "Your unconscious mind has protected you during your entire life from material that might be painful or overwhelming if made conscious. Let it do that now..." (p. 95)

Incorporation works like mental judo in that you use whatever the person is doing, feeling, experiencing and whatever happens to them or around them. In the Oriental martial arts a master never opposes the force of another, but takes that force and utilizes it to move in a new and more useful trajectory.

Exercise #2

Write a second induction for another desired state.

HYPNOTIC RELATIONS ...

There are not only hypnotic words and language patterns, there are also certain *ways of talking and using language* that allows you to create a hypnotic effect.... inviting people to go inside and to use their own references in creating states, meanings, and experiences.

1) Use of Tone and Tempo

Tempo: Use your tempo to match another's breathing and to pace them. This develops a more hypnotic voice. Practice developing a steady voice tempo as you use the person's breathing as the speed... and the rate... and the pace... of the speech. As a powerful mechanism, you can slow down your tempo and watch the impact it has. You can practice gauging your tempo, rate, and rhythm to another's breathing, and then slow down and notice how their breathing also slows down.

Inflection: When you raise your tone at the end of a statement it sounds like a question and engages the conscious mind, to speak with a level voice makes it sound like a statement, and to drop the voice at the end makes it sound like a command. Here *how* we say things matters as much as *what* we say.

Raise Voice	— ↑	*Elicit a Question*
Use Level inflection	— →	*Communicate a Statement*
Bring inflection down	— ↓	*Invoke a Command*

Use hypnosis as a biofeedback by matching breathing rate with your voice tempo and thereby let your behavior become an ongoing feedback mechanism. This enables you to use your analogues to communicate at a level outside of awareness.

"If I tell you I want you to stop ... and consider .... very ... slowly ... just exactly ... what the change ... in your own experience ... was ... then ... the tempo ... the rate of my speech ... the movements of my body (swaying to the rhythm of my speech) don't interfere with the words I'm saying."

2) Pacing and leading.

Pacing-and-leading is the meta-pattern in hypnosis and all effective communication. First pace (to get rapport), then lead. Begin by letting the person lead while you reflect the responses, when you have rapport, lead. Begin by putting yourself into an altered state to invite the other to follow. Mirror the other and notice how quickly the other will follow.

Nonverbal pacing and leading demonstrates how hypnosis operates as feedback. Select messages outside the person's awareness and feed them back.. The power of pacing is seen in how people respond more easily when they're in a state of rapport. Gauge the tempo of your voice to their breathing, blink at their rate of blinking, nod as they nod, rock at the same rate, say things which must in fact be the case, or things that you notice are the case.

In pacing we use words that match what has to be there in another's experience. This builds an unconscious biofeedback loop.

"You can be aware of the temperature of your hand, the sounds in the room, the movement of your body as you breathe."

The person listening can immediately verify these words and as they realize them as accurate representations of experience, this increases credibility. *Pace* current experiences that can be verified by external, sensory-based descriptions.

"You are sitting here, listening to me, looking at me..."

"And as you are listening to the sound of my voice ... and you can feel the warmth where your left hand is resting on your thigh..." "Until I say this sentence, you will be unaware of the temperature and feeling in your left ear."

Then *lead* to non-sensory based understandings.

"... and you can notice the relaxing feelings spread..."

Utilize and incorporate anything that happens, any event, behavior, etc.

"And the noises in the room can help you relax even further."

"And you can be aware of the sound of people shuffling paper in the room."

"Most people can experience one hand as being lighter than another... most can enjoy the refreshing coolness of a light breeze, and I don't know if you can blush easily when you recognize certain feelings within yourself..."

"As the comfort deepens, your unconscious mind can relax while your conscious mind reviews the nature of the problem. And when a relevant or interesting thought reaches your conscious mind, your eyes can close even more so that you can now change it unconsciously."

3) Distract with Content.

In hypnosis, you do not go fast by going quickly. You go fast by going slowly. Put the person's conscious mind in abeyance by switching what's in consciousness and leading to an altered state. When you notice someone is not relaxing, say:

> "You want to relax, but find it difficult because you say to yourself, 'if only I could.' I could tell you, 'Be comfortable,' but it's hard to be comfortable deliberately. Yet it's very easy to think about a raindrop resting on a leaf." (Verbal Swishing)

4) Calibration to the person or persons.

Calibration refers to the process of tuning yourself to the nonverbal signals indicating particular states. Keep calibrating to the person you're working with. Watch how the person responds so that you can vary your behavior to provide a context in which he or she can respond appropriately. Watch people respond and give them what's appropriate. Provide enough different communications until you get the response you want.

5) Facilitating Response Potential or Priming.

"Would you like to find a spot that you can look at comfortably? And as you continue looking at that spot for awhile, can you notice when your eyelids want to blink? And, I don't know, but do they begin to blink together or separately, because I don't know your pattern. Do they blink slowly or quickly? Will they close all at once or flutter first? Will those eyes close more and more as you get more and more comfortable? That's right. Do you best find that your comfort deepens when you keep your eyes closed?"

"And I don't know what will be the most effective means for you to lose weight. Will it be because you simply forget to eat and have little patience with those heavy meals that dull your senses because they prevent you from doing more interesting things?"

Exercise #3

Read your induction to a partner.
Experiencer: Just let the words take you wherever it takes you.
Later— give feedback on wht worked well and what did not.

Exercise #4: Metaphor

Add a metaphor to the induction.
Detect what metaphors are in your induction.

Groups of 3 persons—
1) Identify features of induction.
2) What it is like? What else?
3) Any mixed metaphors?

"TRANCE" IN NEURO-SEMANTICS AND META-STATES

What ideas *entrance* you?

What thoughts or beliefs capture your mind? Are you entranced by the idea of mastery? Would the idea of mastering NLP, Meta-States, or Neuro-Semantics entice you into your future ... and if you were able to recognize the process and development in mastery in the days of this training in such a way that you would feel a growing confidence about it, what would you say is the most significant aspect of that mastery? What if you embedded your life inside of mastery? Are you ready to get on top of anything that gets in your way toward mastery?

We are all easily entranced by ideas, concepts, understandings, models of the world, beliefs, etc. These higher level frames or states of mind create the internal matrix of frames that "hypnotize." These "trance" states are meta-state structures.

Meta-Stating Trance States:

Use Meta-States as an installation process when you use meta-levels to invite a person to texture a primary state with higher level frames. The higher frame operates as an outside of conscious awareness structure. Take thoughts-and-feelings and *go meta* to apply them to other thoughts-and-feelings. Transcend one level of thinking and feeling and include that level inside of another level. All of this layering or texturing occurs *in the mind*, the mind working at multiple levels of awareness.

By definition, a meta-state is a higher level response to a first response, a self-reflexive reaction to our state of mind, body, or emotion. You create it as you layer thought and emotion upon previous thoughts and emotions. As an expression of your self-reflexivity, meta-states move you up into higher order abstractions... which by definition, are "trance" states.

THE METAPHORICAL DIRECTION OF TRANCE IS TRANCE "UP" OR "DOWN?"

So what is the direction of trance? Using the structure of the Meta-Model, it is *up.* It is *up* despite the fact that Bandler and Grinder brought over the "depth" metaphor from Transformational Grammar into NLP. So while they continued to talk about "the deep structure," going "down" into trance, etc., their *meta*-model of language indicated that the higher and more abstract language was *up.*

- How do you think about and conceptualize the *direction* of trance? In which direction is it?
- What direction do you send your consciousness, emotions, and awareness when you go into a trance state?
- What *direction* does your language suggest?
- What *direction* does the "hierarchy of levels" suggest?

Does *the metaphor about trance matter?*

Early NLP used the Transformational Grammar of Chomsky without even questioning it. That led them to talking about trance and hypnosis as "going inside" and activating a Trans-Derivational Search (TDS) to one's personal references. They viewed this as going *down inside* one's mind in the tradition of classical hypnosis.

How can you go *up* into trance? Isn't the direction of trance *down?* Don't you have to float down deeper and deeper into yourself? This identifies the structuring or patterning nature of *meta*phors. *In the trance states of Meta-States and Neuro-Semantics* we have changed the metaphor and are consciously mindful of "going in" and accessing a higher frames of reference or frames of meaning. This makes every Meta-State and NLP pattern a hypnotic pattern to the extent that it invites one to go *up, up and away,* into the higher realms of the mind and to set higher frames and conceptual states. Doing this means that in meta-stating you participate in accessing higher states of mind and move *upward* to your *frames of reference.*

We call this *Meta-Trance* because we have turned the metaphor upside down. We think about the *reference system* as *frames of references*... as the higher frames that establish the very structure and form for the way one thinks.

Conceptually, in *meta-stating* yourself and your states, you access layer upon layer of states—of thoughts, emotions, memories, imaginations, feelings, etc. This takes you *up, up and away*. When you do this, you "space out" or zone out. It's the experience of hypnosis.

Figure 6

Meta-States Higher level T-F as Frames

T-F about previous T-F

Primary State — — > Thoughts & Feelings

TRANSITIONING FROM PRIMARY TO META-STATES

The meta-stating shift from primary state of awareness (focusing on what's "out there") to a meta-level awareness (focusing on what's "inside" your mind and emotions) ... *describes a transition* from primary to meta-levels. This describes a trance phenomenon. As such, it opens up all kinds of insights into the nature of trance as well as how to use trance more conversationally in everyday life.

AS TRANCE PHENOMENA ...

Modeling the Meta-States of an Experience

Consider this meta-stating induction around the subject of "learning."

> Have you ever had an experience that you found so exciting and so thrilling, that learning it didn't seem like learning at all, it was just pure fun and absorption? You know, something like skiing or rollerblading. Some people learn wood working, painting, even reading like that. It's just so much fun.... and I don't know if you can just allow yourself to recall an instant like that... but if you give your brain a chance to *scan through* your history now and identify something like that ... and when you find it, just be there again, fully and completely... seeing, hearing, and feeling it afresh... because when you do, you can begin to *recover the feeling of focused learning.* And as you do, notice just how much you *enjoy and appreciate that experience...* Because as you do, you can *appreciate yourself as a learner*, can you not for the skill of joyful learning. And as you *appreciate yourself*, you can also feel a growing sense of passion or ferociousness increasing about that self-appreciation and about that joyful learning, can you not? And about that ferociousness, you can rise up in your mind to feel a sense of respect for people ... and if you felt a little bit outlandish in your outrageousness about appreciating so fully and completely your total joy of learning... Of course, you could then become *courageous* about the outrageousness of your appreciation of your joyfulness of learning...

As trance phenomena and given that in meta-stating you layer thought and feeling upon thought and feeling, in meta-states *it is trance all the way up*! If you want to track the higher levels of the mind, the higher frames that we use, the frames that *set the frame* for our thinking, feeling, remembering, imagining, etc., then it would look like the following:

Meta-Level — Courageous

Outrageous /Outlandish

Appreciation

Joy/ Delight/ Pleasure

Primary Level Learning ... really learning *About* —— > Something

META-STATE QUALIFICATION QUESTIONS

Sometimes you can use the meta-state structure in asking questions, especially in asking *questions that install qualifications,* that begin a process, that check on the ecology of a new choice, that activates unconscious processes, and that depotentates unuseful resistances.

1. Would you, for a moment or two, allow yourself to become willing to explore this knowing that you do not have to make any change in your thoughts or feelings until you feel twice as resourceful as you do now because you can become more willing to open up new possibilities than you ever imagined possible?

2. Would you, for a few minutes, play around safely with some painful ideas — knowing that these ideas may not even be accurate or useful?

3. Would you, allow yourself to become willing to look at some possible secondary gains that this symptom has provided you, knowing that we humans often develop unconscious secondary gains and that it really means nothing about us, except that we seek to do the best we can for ourselves.

4. How willing do you feel right now from 1 to 10 to go ahead and make this change and how much more willingness would you want in order to make the change from a state of personal strength? That is, to first access a state of strength and use that state to make the change.

5. (If a 7 to 10 response): So you feel that willing and excited as you anticipate making the change— probably because you also can anticipate the value that this will serve for you in some facet of life?

6. (If a 1 to 5 response): Would you allow yourself to become only a little willing to explore making this change as we start so that it feels completely safe? Now I have another question for you. Suppose you refused to continue refusing to make this change?

Assignment:

Write a list of *Qualifying Questions* that you can use in your business that will help to create better response potentials in others.

1. How curious would you like to feel as you begin to engage in this workshop?
2. How much confidence would you like to develop about the information in using it and working with it?
3. Would you enjoy having fun with this model first and foremost or would you want to first develop more exquisite skill in handing it?
4. How silly could you imagine yourself feeling about talking this way before you become hypnotically competent with it?
5. Would you like to resist any part of this information or just observe it first and then take your own sweet time in deciding which parts you want to incorporate?
6. Levels of alertness vary in trainings— how alert would you like to be throughout this process— and to what extent would you like to sink down into a relaxed meditative state

and absorb it in at that level?
7. Knowing your meta-programs as you do— do you need to let yourself shift any of them in order to maximize your full usage of this training?
8. How comfortable and resourceful would you want to stay as a person with a great sense of innate value and dignity when receiving criticism?
9. Can you yet gracefully install the process of a learning while you learn the content? Would you want to allow yourself to do that today.

Exercise #5: Meta-Stating Questions (15 min)

1) Invent 3 to 5 questions to elicit some useful and powerfully positive meta-states in others in your particular field or in personal relationships. Identify a primary state experience (positive or negative). Identify the qualities.
2) Speak them conversationally. What 5 sentences that you can use in your work that conversationally meta-states.
3) Get feedback and repeat.

Exercise #6: Meta-Stating Blessings Confirmation / Acknowledgement

1) Identify a blessing that you or another needs.
Do you need a blessing? Does someone else need a blessing?
Write 5 statements that pronounce a blessing or benediction.

"May you thoroughly **enjoy** *your discoveries* as **your curiosity** *explores* afresh and activates *your memory* in new and delightful ways making you more creative and insightful than ever before, now!" "I trust that you will find yourself **enraptured** *in an ecstatic kind of joy* about your new *learnings* as you read and discover either afresh or anew more powerful and impactful ways to apply all of your NLP learnings, knowing that you will begin to surprise yourself in applying your more refined skills in ways that make life more enjoyable."

Meta-State Invocation: "Now as you begin to learn with an excited anticipation of the curious and wonder-filled things you might find in this model, may you **ferociously** *enjoy* **your learning** and **find yourself** *appreciating* **your skill** for implementing just those things that would truly enhance and ennoble your life! And you can do this with a growing sense of **appreciation** for your *creativity* as you **enjoy** *watching yourself* **with confidence** and *wondering* **excitedly** how much this will improve your *flexibility* and *resourcefulness.*"

2) Improvisional meta-stating blessings.
Without writing or figuring it out... speak meta-stating blessings to each other.
Free your tongue for translating immediately from mind to mouth.
Example of a Therapeutic Communication: This was spoken to young man who had a "hot temper" and tended to respond in polarities and in a know-it-all way:
"I have puzzled for several days... and I don't know the answer to a question, and don't know if you know the answer to the question or even if you could find the answer if you really tried... but I've been wondering that *if* you had the absolute ability to *be un-insultable* because your sense of your innate dignity felt so secure that it gave you the freedom to always turn down an invitation to take insult no matter how much insult someone tried in

vain to offer you... I'm just wondering how that would effect your everyday experience in driving in traffic, at work, and at home."

Exercise #7: Designer State Induction

1) Identify a primary state that you want more power over.
   What PS do you sometimes experience that you would like to have more resourcefulness with? Menu list: receiving criticism, needing to take on a challenge, etc.
2) Specify the meta-state structure that you want to build. Build 2 or 3 levels.
   What meta-state would you like to have about that primary state?
   What meta-levels or frames would texture it so that you can feel and be more resourceful?
   Menu List: playful about criticism, just feedback, etc.
3) Induce the state.
   Language the experience of entering the states. Use linkage words to tie the language together.

MODELING AND HYPNOTIC LANGUAGE

What hypnotic language patterns are in the old strategy? Which hypnotic language patterns are needed for the new strategy?

How do we break the old post-hypnotic suggestions?
How do we set up the new post-hypnotic suggestions?
How then to induce a person into the state of thinking and feeling of the new strategy?

META-LINGUISTICS FOR HIGHER LEVELS

When you move into meta-levels, you move above and beyond the sensory-based modality language of the VAK and from sensory-based words into more and more abstract and conceptual terms. To increase awareness regarding this realm of meta-levels, you need to increase our awareness of *the language of meta-states and meta-levels*. The following offers **linguistic cues** which you can use to signal ourselves about MS.

1) State-about-state syntax.

If a PS refers to something outside our nervous system, "I fear John." "I dislike that job." "I hate it when they talk that way." then a MS refers to a state-about-a-state: "I fear my fear." "I feel calm about my anger." Listen for the juxtaposition of two states--one state referencing another.

2) Meta words.

Many words imply a meta position. "Of, about, regarding, that, beyond, concerning, transcend, etc." "I feel upset **about** my stress..." "Well, **regarding** my grief about my dad's death, I feel..."

Buried underneath the concept of ... limitation

Bear in mind	Hidden in an upper corner of the mind
Keep in mind	Uppermost in mind
Above and beyond	In terms of
In view of	As you realize
With this realization	As you remember those feelings

From a more X — (realistic, objective, compassionate) point of view

What are you holding in mind about...

Let's now apply that to.... Even more importantly,

Rise up in your mind	Overall
Overview	As an over-riding principle

Get on top of your X (depression, anger, anger)

3) "Self"-words.

Generally speaking, the word "self" with a hyphen indicates a meta-state: self-confidence, self-esteem, self-celebration, self-contempt, self-analysis, self-conscious, etc. Exceptions do occur: self-hypnosis.

4) Classifications.

Whenever we hear classification kind of words (groups, levels, degrees, etc.) or statements that describe or presuppose levels of classifications--we probably have a rare and unprecedented opportunity to pull back the structural curtain on the reality before us and discover meta-states.

5) Quotations and narratives.

A sneaky way that Bandler and Grinder often worked with meta-states (w/o using that terminology) involved layering consciousness through the use of "quotes." They would tell a story, open up a narrative, and within that description put another quote of a quote. Such layering of various thoughts-representations-emotions (states) would create larger and larger levels of frames and contexts (each inducing or accessing various states).

NLP Trainers' Training teaches one how to open up a training with a quote or narrative story and open up another and another, etc., get to the middle of the presentation where we would put **the main point,** and then start closing the loops one by one. That kind of eloquence of presentation meta-states an entire audience.

6) Logical level shifts.

Some words, terms, and phrases shift one from one level of consciousness to a higher level. Consider,

"I know that she means well, **but** I feel really hurt by what she did."

Here, the word *"but"* tends to negate the previous words. It negates, "She means well." The speaker now shifts the focus to "she hurt me." It does not say, "She does not mean well," although we often hear it as meaning such. It simply shifts to a higher logical level.
We experience the "but" as shifting us from the lower level of awareness and emotion to a higher state that then drives and permeates the lower state. By contrast, notice the effect of *"and."*

"I know that she means well, **and** I feel really hurt by what she did."

This keeps the thoughts-emotions on the same logical level which then has an additive effect (adding this state to that state) which in NLP usually has the effect of collapsing the two states together.

7) ***Adjectives that qualify states.***

Gladly embrace
Tolerable anxiety
Unacceptable grief
Unconscious thinking
Deliberate inhibition
Forgetting to deliberately inhibit
Proudly stubborn @ my resourcefulness

Bitterly criticize
Sharing hesitantly
Stubbornly insistent
Helpless defeatism
Ferocious resolve
Ferocious attachment

8) ***Pseudo-feeling terms.***

In English, we call many things "emotions" or "feelings" which do not exist as "emotions" or "feelings" at all. We do so by using a syntactic environment like "I feel..." and then add some judgment to it. This usually indicate a meta-level. If you ask "and how do you feel about that?" you can usually get a real feeling that has kinesthetic qualities. Ah, an A_d state!

I feel like a king (royal)
I feel like I need closure
I feel like spectacular
I feel helpless
She felt horrified that she might learn something new!
I feel alienated (unreal, weird)
He felt like he was being born again
I feel dumb/ stupid
I feel marvelous (fantastic, incredible, clever)
I feel like an object (at loose ends)

9) Multi-Ordinal Terms, **Multiordinality (MO)**

In GS, Korzybski designated a word that means different things at different levels of abstraction as a ***"multi-ordinal"*** term. Such terms have *ambiguous* meanings and so can lead to arguments, confusions of orders, and semantic disturbances. Multiordinal terms only have definite meanings on a given level and in a given context. Before we can argue about them, we need to fix their *order,* or identify the level.

Multiordinal terms gives us the ability to talk with sense and sanity about logical levels. Because

we can use multiordinal terms with reference to different logical levels, we have to specific the level to understand its meaning.

Examples: reality, state, science, meaning, love, yes, no, true, false, function, relation, difference, problem, cause, effect, evaluation.

MO terms have different meanings on different levels of abstractions. Their general meanings vary depending upon the context or level. Korzybski (1933):

"If we reflect upon our languages, we find that at best they must be considered only as maps. A word is not the object it represents, and languages exhibit also this peculiar self-reflexiveness... this self-reflexiveness of languages introduces serious complexities, which can only be solved by the theory of multiordinality..." (58).

Testing for M.O.: Check whether you can apply it to itself.

Do you love John? Do you love loving John? Do you love loving love? Do you have a prejudice? Suppose you had a prejudice against that prejudice?

10) Presupposing a state-on-a-state.

"It must feel really hard to have to pretend that you can please her, knowing that you never have and probably never will." Paces: "I appreciate your overall difficulty." MS: (Pretend) to please. Gestalt: placate.

"It sounds like you have already come to the realization that your anxiety about your masculinity takes you nowhere useful."

"It seems that you'd like to say or do X, but to do so, you'd be selfish, mean, etc."

"What would you feel if you could pretend to do X thinking it meant you knew how to protect your personal boundaries, and then forgot you were pretending?"

"I can appreciate how fearful it would be to X on the one hand, and yet on the other hand, it would feel exciting..."

11) Meta-State Questions.

Ask questions that presuppose eliciting meta-states that enable the person to become more resourceful.

"What relationship exists between C-E statements and experience?

How important do you think it becomes to take this understanding into consideration as you engage in ...? (Importance of) (Understanding) some PS experience.

What does all of this lead to? (C-E awareness of) (future representations) @ PS experience.

12) Nominalization of Nominalizations

the ugly side of his personality comes out under pressure
the pace of modern life goes too fast for me
his emotional health
the pressures of his responsibilities
His lack of moral fiber
his ego is very fragile

TA-STATING IN STATEMENTS AND QUESTIONS

Take each statement and put parenthesis (...) around words and phrases that modify the next word or words that indicate states. The first sentence serves as a sample.

1. "I'm (wondering) (just how willing) (you feel) as we begin this process of learning about meta-states? Do you (feel) some anticipation for learning this or would you say that, even now, you have a (ferocious spirit) about (learning) this learning?

2. Oh yes, I know that "ferocious learning" may sound like a strange phrase, but don't let that put you off. I'm using it to assist you in becoming more calm and relaxed in your learning and not to jump too quickly into lustful learning.

3. Now this guy over here looks like he's anticipating a great weekend— wouldn't you say? I'd guess he already feels excited about anticipating improving his skills and personal effectiveness and already jumping into his future and deliberately planning... no, powerfully planning, how to apply this model more thoroughly and elegantly in his communications — or at least he is certainly doing that now, can he not?

4. Now what outcome can you begin to anticipate from this training? Good question. I think you can comfortably realize that you can enjoy learning a new and very different model about the structure of human functioning and experiencing. I plan to have fun presenting this and trust you will find yourself also having more playful and humorous fun in your learning.

5. You can anticipate an increase in your confidence about communication skills, about negotiating, and about working with people. If you want to go ahead and appreciate yourself for having made this decisions to spend this weekend and invest your time and energy into this learning —please feel free to do that, but only to the extent that you can truly admire your own human ability to want to expand consciousness and skills.

6. Do you enjoy anticipating, improving personal skills? Good. Do you also enjoy enjoying anticipating improved personal skills?

7. I know a guy who loved a particular gal. He was the kind of guy though who also really loved loving the gal. But then years later when I met him, he loved his loving of his love— in other words, I think he had become infatuated with his infatuation with her.

8. So as you allow yourself to enter into this experience and training fully so you can suck out of it all of the nourishment that will precisely enrich your life—you can like your lips about the delicious learnings that you will enjoy.

9. Knowing that if anything doesn't fit for yourself you can say, 'No thanks, I'd rather have a moment-by-moment experience of increasing my effectiveness.'

10. Because you can realize that you always can become aware of your choices, and then choose the choice that you believe will most enrich your life.

11. Now with the particular processes that we will explore in this model— you may find yourself lost at times. When that happens, please allow yourself to not only enjoy the silliness of feeling

conceptually lost because your brain has gotten on some other train of thought and taken you many miles away before you noticed—but I want to encourage you to play with this experience, especially by noticing it, observing it, riding along with it. Then when you so choose, you can allow your hand to rise— slowly and involuntarily, and hear yourself say,'Would you please repeat that one—one more time?' and then you can step aboard and ride along with the rest of us.

12. This workshop focuses about tracking down where brains go and in developing more skill with our own subjectivity (our subjective experiences) and those of others. Why? Because the human factor always and inevitably plays such a major factor in business and in communicating.

13. Managing and controlling our own subjectivity and more effectively assisting others with theirs—so that we can all feel in charge of our thoughts, feelings, speech, and behavior, and functioning at our best, this enables us to become more persuasive, creative, respectful, effective, etc.

14. In working with human subjectivity we find much complexity, so that few models of human thoughts, feelings, and behavior can handle most f the actual facets of humans—especially the levels of awareness and levels of emotion that we access.

15. As you allow yourself now to begin to experience the workshop—I think you might find it useful if you step aside from yourself— observationally to notice this fact—here you are at a workshop seeking to learn something of value —and you can develop this meta-part in such a way so as to both experience and to observe things.

17. As we begin, I think you might want to fully realize that as words function as vehicles of meaning —symbols that elicit referents, that you can think of big words as especially valuable and rich —as offering you a tightly packed package carrying much meaning.

18. Now, I'd like you to take a relaxed, confident attitude toward this learning. Because as you believe in your own creativity as you ever-increasing ability to learn you can release trying, and just playfully enjoy the process in a calm expectation of feeling surprised and delighted in how quickly you learn, because you can.

19. If at any time you begin to feel uncomfortable, troubled, distressed—then I want you to allow yourself to float along with those emotions —the states that induces and just notice, comfortably, the T-F that arise—and to do so in a joyful anticipation of some really valuable growth that will follow. Welcome your inner states, love your neurosis as they arise, while enjoying the process knowing that your states occur in time, only last temporarily, will pass, do not comprise the real you, are just made up of T-F.

FROM THE PATTERN OF ACCESSING PERSONAL GENIUS TO AN INDUCTION

Genius refers to a committed state in which you are totally engaged with some focus so that as a result, the world goes away, your sense of self goes away, and time vanishes. As your focus becomes increasingly intentional, you develop a laser-beam focus. In APG, you ran the pattern, *Accessing Personal Genius.* Here you will do an induction of that pattern. Begin with inducing a nice relaxing light trance.

***1) Start with an Observing* State.**

As you *feel calm,* you can imagine a pure and discreet state of just observing something, a state wherein you just notice some sights and sounds around you in this room. And as you do, you can more fully relax all of your muscles so that you can observe even more clearly.

2) Access a new desired engagement state.

And you can wonder, "What focused state would I like to design and create for myself?" And as you think about some of the things that you do— whether on a daily basis like reading and writing and having a conversation, or things you do occasionally, like playing chess, building something I your workshop, playing tennis, etc., what would you like to create today? And what do you call this new engagement state? Then, as you think about it, you can begin to *experience it a little bit* and begin to *go into that state.* And as you access a bit of it, seeing what you see, hearing what you hear, and feeling what you feel, go there now and *be with it* fully. And you can let it grow and expand so that you have more and more of it. And you can use your imagination using the "What If..:" question to invite it even more. And when you have accessed this state, let it keep expanding until you reach a level of 6 or 7 or more and nod when you have that.

3) Shift in and out of this engagement state.

Now imagine ... and this can be very strange ... that you step out of it ... something interrupts you ... and now step back into that engagement as fully as possible ... nod when you have done that... that's right. And you can imagine stepping out cleanly, leaving the state intact, and as you step back in at your command. Very good.

And what would it be like if you imagined this engagement state inside of a protective bubble, a bubble that protects and secures this engagement state, wouldn't that be wonderful? And as you step in and out of your engagement experience, you can practice making a clean state shift and to do that you will be noticing the distinctions which allow you know how you can call it back it upon cue.

4) Developing your engagement state.

Now as you enter into this engagement state, there's another part of your mid— the part that makes up your mind and that sets boundaries for things, and as you now rise up in your mind to that part of your mind which also makes decisions, you can begin to consider the boundaries of your engagement state. You can wonder about why want this state? Why is it valuable to you? And as you consider the why, you can begin to discover your reasons, agendas, and motivations, can you not?

And how should you engage in this state of focus? Do you know the way and style that you bring to this state? How enables you to know what to do and what not to do because this speaks to your criteria and qualities. And knowing how allows you also to consider when you should or can step into this state. When should you and when should you not? And where is the best place or places

for engaging in this activity? And where is not a good place? Because when and where are about the context or contexts that you are even now choosing.

And when you are engaged, does this particular engagement involve someone else and if it does, then who? And that also enables you to decide with whom not to invite into this engagement? And you can now consider the significance and meaning of this engagement? What meanings do you give to this and what meanings would you never give to it?

5) Commission your executive mind and future pace.

With all of these boundaries, is there a part of you that's willing to take full responsibility for setting these parameters for this engagement state so you can fully experience it without even having to think about it? And if so, then nod when you get that confirmation from within and be sure to thank that part of you for that commitment.

Is that executive part also willing to take responsibility for letting you fully experience the intense state, unconsciously knowing its and boundaries, that is, when to have it and when not, how to have it and how not, and is it willing to signal you when to step out? So now imagine moving out into your future fully aligned with this and able to turn your flow state or engagement state on and off at your command.

Exercise #8: ***Induction for Personal Genius***

Building Hypnotic Inductions of the *Accessing Personal Genius* Training

Part I:

1) Refresh the process that you experienced in accessing your personal genius. Sketch out a brief outline of the key steps that enabled you to step into that experience. After you have the bare-bone skeleton of the process, fill in each step with as many of the details as you currently remember.

2) Use the "Accessing your Personal Genius" Pattern and re-access that state.

3) Complete your outline yet another time by filling in more of the details ... writing out more of the induction that you experienced.

Part II:

4) Using the Meta-Level Linguistics along with the other hypnotic language patterns, edit your current draft. Update the language that you've used adding in touches of meta-levels that provide the hypnotic language to enrich the induction.

5) Put yourself into a creative, playful, and hypnotic inducing state and then re-write the entire Genius Induction from scratch.

Part III: Genius Induction Script

1) Use the review of how to hypnotically communicate verbally to mark your Genius Induction so as to cue a reader for the following:

Embedded commands, questions, and statements
Indication of voice going down, up, and level
Shift of speed ... squeezing meaning by slowing down ... speeding up, etc.
Pauses

2) Exchange scripts and become fully acquainted with your partners script ... inviting feedback and further refinement.

3) Induce a trance state and read your partner's script to him or her, then exchange so that you get to receive your induction.

GENIUS INDUCTION

L. Michael Hall

Initiating the Induction...

As I turn my thoughts to the delight of writing and researching ... I find myself suddenly in my favorite coffee shop, the one I visit every morning in Colorado and there I smell the coffee and bagels and all of the smells of the shop and I hear the rustle of voices as people are up about a new day ... and as I feel a pen in my hand, I find that as I'm reading and making notes ... and that my mind is alive with ideas and feelings and thoughts... That the internal cinema of my consciousness has been activated ... knowing that what I'm reading is and will feed my creativity and ability to extend the things I can do and the new products I can invent.

I feel a growing anticipation in the larger context of a calmness that allows me to read and think at my best, making vivid movies that I step in and out of as I write. I feel that I live my life in a larger frame of being free to do what I do best and what I love best, I get to explore the dimensions of mind and body and human excellence. *And they pay me for this stuff!* I can't believe it! What a privilege! And this will increase in the years to come to become even richer and fuller and I wonder what will emerge from the readings and trainings and writings... and when I will write my first best seller and get national and international attention for NLP and Neuro-Semantics. And I know it will happen, and it doesn't even have to be me ... perhaps it will be someone that I have had the privilege of training, and they get to go first, and then I'll write my own best seller as a follow-up to theirs.

Where and When

As I step into this Creative Researching and Writing State when I'm at the coffee shop it allows me the ability to do so whenever and wherever I choose ... although I choose mostly to do it at the computer when I'm in my office ... facing the south with the Mesa Mountain to my right as I look out the east window and mountains to the south ... and I can do it on airplanes or in crowded airports ... or at a table somewhere... the place is, for the most part, irrelevant... although at any time when a loved one calls, or an emergency happens, or when I'm needed ... I can simply step out of this state ... leaving it fully intact, that I can make an impeccable state shift and return to this and pick up precisely where I have left off.

How

And whenever I begin, the ideas and the words just flow... easily, comfortably... usually at just the right speed ... but sometimes faster than I can type... but that's just fine because I can and will remember them ... because I make vivid and dynamic movies in my mind ... whether when I'm running and walk or driving and can always recall them. And in writing, I can write again and re-write until I get it right .. So I don't have to write right the first time, so I can free flow in the writing. I do so playfully, knowing that it is in playfulness and fun that I do my best thinking and creating and writing... and I can easily get the feeling of being playful and even silly by recalling wonderful instances of such.

And when I am researching and writing, I do so knowing that it's just an expression of my creativity and that it does not prove anything. I don't need this to become a somebody, my somebody-ness is a given and this is just an expression of my gifts, experiences, and knowledge and so I read and write without any pressure ... just because it's fun and because I never know when I'll feel surprised by a new insight or discovery. I may set out plans and goals, even deadlines and

objectives, but I don't have to reach them in any given order or way... it will occur and it will occur as I write and discover new things and that's the fun of it all.

Why

And of course, I read and write, I research and interview and do lots of the things involved in this process so that I can produce articles and books and trainings and training manuals and I know that helps with making a living, and in creating multiple sources of income, and to influence people around the world, and to express my ideas, to get clear in my own mind... and yet for all of that ... I do it as a way to learn and to become richer and fuller on the inside. I do it to play with ideas and words and to become more of a craftsman of language and to wonder about the structure of even higher level states and experiences that enable us all to be so much more. And so this is my magic carpet ride ... a ride I take every day and everywhere ... just for the fun of it.

Induction:

And now, before you begin to prevent yourself from going all the way into a new genius state — a state of focused mastery, a state of intense purpose and intentionality, I want to invite you to take a moment to reclaim and to refresh the states of excellence that you have been accessing during the past days ... because you can and will use your skills at running your own brain to become more resourceful than you have ever before ... now... as you prepare yourself to go there ... I want you to respond only as profoundly as you need to respond at this point in time, knowing that you can use this as the beginning of a process that you can use anytime and every time you need to access a focused state ... and that this is just the beginning of what you can do ... so that this just prepares you for ever-increasing your skills and mastery ... in your —

Power zone.. "Mine"
Acceptance ... appreciation ... awe
Yes and No
Pleasures
Concepts
Miracle thinking ... solution thinking in a new space
Ability to implement
Intentionality
Focus
Alignment
grace
Mindfulness
Fallibility
Resilience

GENIUS INDUCTION

Mumtaz Vishal, M.B.B.S.

As I see myself sitting down at my desk, calligraphy brush in my hand, I feel the flow of the ink and appreciate the emerging patterns and elegance of the brush-strokes on the delicate rice paper. I am aware of the sound of birds in the trees outside, and strains of Mozart playing in the background. It is peaceful, and I feel so serene and meditative. I feel relaxed, alert, receptive and joyful - I get to express myself and to be myself.

This is what I love doing and it is easy to be focused, so totally focused and absorbed, observing the magic of that precise moment when one drop of ink meets and melts into the fibrous surface of the paper. Cocooned in this bubble of concentration, I only have one focus that takes me to the essence of what I am doing so that I get the best and most out of it. I call this my **total state.** The Total State primes my whole being towards achieving my goals, my highest aims, which give meaning to my life.

Bringing this one-pointed focus of concentration with me, I rise up in my mind to that part that makes decisions. Accessing this, my Controller, I invite it to take complete charge and control when and where I should experience the Total State, the state of total focus and absorption. Cueing me into this state, determining how long it is appropriate for me to remain in it and letting me know when it is time to come out of it, leaving me free to lose myself in doing what will lead me to the attainment of my goals.

Guided by my Controller, I enter the Total State when I am in a learning mode, or when I am listening attentively to someone who seeks my help, and when I want to give my full attention to the job in hand. I trust the wisdom and sensitivity of my Controller to subtly vary the mood, the depth, the quality and texture of my Total State to suit each particular activity.

Even while I am fully absorbed in the Total State, I comfortably allow myself to be interrupted when necessary, so that I can see to the things that need my immediate attention. And when that happens, I take a snapshot of what I am doing at that moment and then I can leave the Total State cleanly, protected in its bubble and return to it intact, as and when I can, picking up where I left off. As I commission my Controller to tune into my clear internal signals indicating when I have completed a job, or when it is appropriate to leave one, it will cue me to come out of the Total State. Fully and cleanly.

I give my Controller full permission to constantly track and refine the workings of the Total State, in a way that will fully support the attainment of my goals. To texture the Total State with compassion and love, with a sense of humour and acceptance of my human fallibility, and the ability to celebrate my achievements, no matter how small. To add grace and richness to my life, I would also go into the Total State, bringing the appropriate focus and absorption when I am enjoying my creative activities like calligraphy, painting and reading.

I now ask my Controller if it is prepared to take full responsibility for setting these parameters so that I can fully experience the Total State. (Pause) This Total State is mine and I guard it jealously. It is mine and I get to integrate it into my life to help me stay focused on my goals, making my commitment steadfast and attainable.

As I go through life from this day on, I take this Total State with me, accessing it anytime I want to get into that state of total focus and concentration. And with that, I am unstoppable!

USING TRANCE

There are a great many contexts wherein you can use trance— in training, in coaching, consulting, parenting, negotiating, selling, leading, and the list goes on and on.

1) Start with the General State of Trance

Relaxation— calmness. So use words, images, tones, tempos, etc. that induce a calm relaxed state. Slow things down—breathe fully and completely, stretch, yawn, release, let go. Use imagines of floating ... floating down, going down deeper and deeper still. Use adown pillow and float down in your bed in a relaxing sleep or sleepy eyes. Allow an escalator that you down deeper to the foundational level. Floating on water. Alice falling down the hole and finding Wonderland.

2) Give the Mind something to Grab onto

Feed the mind something to fully represent visually, auditorially, kinesthetically, linguistically, conceptually, etc.

Examples: Decontamination Chamber pattern; Magical forest and castle; Healing pools.

3) Start with an Induction

Prime your coaching, training, communications with an induction that prepares for the responses that you want.

Examples: Intentionality Pattern; The Movie Rewind Pattern.

4) End with an Induction

Use as a review. "Let's now review what we've learned ..."

BEGINNING INDUCTIONS IN A TRAINING

As we begin today, I want to invite you to take a moment to **close your eyes** and *imagine fully and vividly* one thing that you would like to improve in your life .... now it could be an attitude, it could be how you handle your emotions, or one particular emotion, it could be an activity that you do— at work, in a relationship ... just one thing that will improve the quality of your life.

... and as you begin to dream a dream about becoming more resourceful or more skilled in that area... why not *feel* joyfully resourceful ... or feel confidently competent in that area because as you realize that you can... if you have the right tools and now let yourself wonder what will think and feel when you discover that this training is even now giving you those tools— the tools to run your own brain, drive your own bus, and take charge of your life ... and as you do that, you can then design your future so it makes your dreams come true.

And I wonder how empowering that will be for you and how you will feel as your confidence grows and as it becomes self-efficacy— and you can wonder, "What new doors of opportunity will be opening for me?"

And as these mental tools, emotional tools, linguistic tools, relational tools enable you to move out into your future, you can now anticipate the development of new resources ... and given that, how curiously playful can you be as that happens? And what new discoveries will you make from the things you've learned here as you reflect back on the learnings that you've made in these days and let them become even more.

Induction

Now I wouldn't ask you to **feel totally enthused** @ all the rich possibilities of going meta to higher levels, at least, I wouldn't ask you to do that now—here at the beginning. So I would ask you to give yourself permission to begin to feel curious about getting excited about the possibilities regarding the wonderful things you will discover that will expand your personal resourcefulness now...

Because I won't want you to just **jump too far ahead** of the process and become too skilled in state management. I will only ask that you be playful @ your excitement knowing that in the playground of life you can experiment with how much fun you have in celebrating yourself and your skills in running your own brain.

You are about to embark on a journey —and enter into another dimension. A dimension of time and space a dimension of mind and emotion, a dimension of consciousness that creates heavens and hells, delights and dreads, hopes and hates. In this dimension, we will travel to distant pasts and future wonders, we will explore conceptual realities easily articulated and those beyond all words.

A feeling has brought you to this domain of mind and emotion, a feeling in your mind that often sends you in loops— round and round in circles and yet with that you have a sense that if only you could control that looping— your genius could emerge. And you want to know what this is— and now you can enjoy the realization that it simply describes the meta-levels or meta-layering of your mind, levels within levels, and layers within layers.

And you can now know for sure that MS is a discovery of a Key to unravel the layering of your mind so you can see its richness and power and build up the kind of layering that will texture your life.

TRANCE FOR MANAGING PAIN

Pain management is one of the most wonderful of all hypnotic phenomenon. It is also eminently useful. It addresses the complex phenomenon of "pain" as it enables us to induce states for losing awareness of pain. [The following page numbers refers to Erickson's book, *Healing in Hypnosis*, Vol. I.)

Priming for Creating Response Potentials

First, develop an *attitude* toward yourself or others that will greatly help elicit the results you want. Expectation is an important curative factor. Use your expectation as a psychological shock by letting the person know that they are going to be cured. With an utterly confidence communicate, "A cure is going to take place in you!" As an away-from, Erickson would frequently set up situations of emotional dread for people-- situations in which they would begin to expect something utterly devastating to occur if they didn't comply and engage the cure.

> "The utterance of one single word right now could bring a flush to your face. That's right because your body has had a lot of experience in controlling the flow of blood and it's so easy and so simple. If you can control the flow of blood to your face, to your neck, why not a little bit below."
>
> "Consider the way in which your body has had experience in turning pale at the thought of something terrifying. Consider the way your body has had many experiences in turning red under heat, and the way it turns white under cold. Your body has had a lot of experience. There's a tremendous wealth of actual physiological experience that warrants the expectation that one could build up a hypnotic situation to control capillary flow of blood; and with that capillary flow of blood you could also control salivary glands, or you could stimulate those glands. You can say a single word to someone that will produce warts. This wealth of knowledge existing in your body manifests itself when given the right psychological or physiological stimulation."

Second, Set a new frame about the subjective nature of Pain

Pain is a construct (a mental understanding). It exists at the verbal level, not the sensory level. Pain is primarily a conscious, subjective experience that has unpleasant, threatening and dangerous emotional significance. Pain is a complex construct, composed of past remembered pain, present pain, and anticipated pain (p. 219). Most people experience pain as an immediate, subjectively negative sensation. It is all-encompassing of attention, distressing, and seemingly uncontrollable. Pain is a complex characterized by multiple understandings by the sufferer.

Third, Create a Context for a New Response.

Since a little adrenalin in an emergency can be useful and too much can be incapacitating, then for tasks requiring fine coordination (like fixing a watch), too much adrenalin messes it up. What to do? Induce a receptive state and context in which the natural response is to miss pain. Create a context in which nobody is going to be aware of pain. Imagine a hungry tiger, licking its chops and staring at you! Does pain exist when you're about to be eaten? An experience where there's no pain is something that can be anchored and continued as a particular altered state. If the context compelling enough that will distract you from the pain.

Pain Management Techniques

1) Distracting consciousness away from pain.

Distract so that you forget pain. An amazing thing is that some people continue to keep their tensions and pains. So when you distract, pain has less of a chance of capturing your consciousness. By reflecting on severely crucial situations, you can realize that the severest of pain vanishes when the focusing of awareness is compelled by more intense or even life-threatening stimuli (p. 218).

By recognizing that the unconscious tendency is to rely on memories, ideas, and concepts rather than concrete reality. That's why it's easy to hallucinate. You can substitute the pain for a memory of a very pleasant feeling and take attention away from the concrete reality of pain. You can direct it to a very real experience of learning or experience of comfort in the unconscious (p. 102).

Instant forgetting is easy in the hypnotic state. Even in a conscious state, compelling worries, fears, pains can be lost instantaneously at the sight of an automobile accident. You simply forget them. How does the brain abolish overwhelming subjective experiences just because another visual experience intervenes (p. 183)?

As the communication of ideas in a way that maximizes a person's receptivity to what is presented, hypnosis motivates you to explore your body potentials for controlling physiological and psychological responses. The body has learned a wealth of unconscious psychological, emotional, neurological, and physiological associations which are the source of potentials for controlling pain.

Distract consciousness by asking about the person's favorite childhood experiences. Continue this until it completely person's awareness. What was your favorite activity as a child and would you elaborate? Carefully raise the question so you slide past the difficulty, the problem, as you start up a new train of thought and emotion which precludes feeling pain (p.128). To a child Erickson asks, "How many stitches do you think this cut needs?" (p. 42).

Distract to a strong overwhelming pleasure. Set up an association from pain to pleasure. Talk about pleasures and joys from last summer. Emphasize comfort, physical ease, joys, satisfactions. Guide the association of ideas along channels that support the person. Invite him to lose himself in your association of ideas as in a suspenseful movie.

Once Erickson fixed a man's attention on the expectation that the pain would be so brief that *he might miss it*. " I also encouraged him to feel the pain by fixing his attention on it because he might *miss it*, because it was so brief." (The word "might" miss it--suggests the possibility.)

Present ideas that will facilitate shortening the subjective time frame of the unpleasant experience. Ask a child, "How fast will the needle go into the skin in suturing the wound." "Notice really notice how fast! Rreally pay attention because you might miss it."

The magician who says "the hand is faster than the eye," is first setting you up to expect that he will move his hand very rapidly. He will then be very careful not to move it too fast since that is what you're expecting. He will moves it much more slowly than you anticipate and your eyes are jumping ahead of the hand movement so that you don't see all of the movement.

Distract to reframe. Relaxation involves feeling inertia— an unwillingness to move. "Your legs are too heavy to lift, your arms are too heavy to move, you feel too relaxed for movement of any kind, and along with that relaxation you get a feeling of warmth—a feeling of rosy, comfortable warmth" (p. 222). You dissect the pain as you get the person to recognize its various attributes.

2) Fragment: Fractualize the Components of pain.

Pain can be viewed in temporal terms: It is experienced as transient, recurrent, persistent, acute, chronic. It can be viewed in emotional terms: irritating, troublesome, all-compelling, incapacitating, distressing, depressing, intractable, vitally dangerous. It can be viewed in terms of sensations: dull, heavy, draggy, sharp, cutting, twisting, burning, nagging, stabbing, lancinating, biting, cold, hot, hard, grinding, throbbing, gnawing. Since we have many ways to view pain, invite the person to fully describe his pain. With this "divide and conquer technique" you can then help a person to reframe (reinterpret) the pain.

Ask: Which pain should I approach first? The lancinating one or the burning one? Or the heavy, dragging pain? Should I take care of the cutting pain next or the burning pain? To this the person will immediately divide his pain experience into separate kinds of pain. It's easer to communicate ideas about pain after you dissect the total experience. Use this displacement to build up a displacement of pain from one part of the body to another.

Fractionalizing breaks a threshold. Whenever you start picking things apart, you destroy them and destroy its value (p. 118). Example: Gagging. Where does the gagging really start: abdomen, thorax, pharynx? Gradually eradicate things in parts. You don't have to annihilate the whole thing at once (p. 199). What are the component parts of the experience? Take a person's all-inclusive, comprehensive, phobic reaction to dogs in general and narrow it down to this particular dog.

Pain typically involves a lot of symptomatology. Collect them and then fragment. Implied in this is that the person is willing to have the symptoms. "How long do you want to have that headache? Are you willing to have a headache for 2 or 3 seconds?" The willingness to have a headache implies a willingness also to control it (p. 119).

"You know how the first mouthful of dessert tastes so very good? And even the second mouthful still tastes good; but by the time you reach the sixty-sixth mouthful, it doesn't taste so good. You have lost the liking for it, and the taste of the dessert has changed in some peculiar way. It hasn't become bad; it had just 'died out' in flavor. Now, as you pay attention to these various sensations in your body, I would like you to name the particular sensation that you want me to work on first."

What's the effect of this? You transform the pain to a single sensation.

3) Dissociation: Step aside from the pain.

Move the person out of the pain or move the pain somewhere else. "When you get an attack of pain, it would be awfully nice if you get into that bed on the other side of the room and leave your aching, painful body all by its lonesome self in the usual bed." This dissociation induces an anesthesia. Have them move to another part of the room, leaving their pain where they were (p. 233).

"Can you feel the pain over there in that corner of the room? In the living room?" Build up

that dissociation bit by bit. This changes the person's subjective experience.

4) Disorientation / Reorientation — Change the person's reality orientation.

Take away the sense of feeling through hypnotic anesthesia or analgesia by asking the client to make an entirely different kind of reality orientation. First ask him to lose a certain amount of his reality contact. Alter it. Develop a "funny" feeling toward things. Analgesia) means a loss of pain sensation but not the loss of tactile sensation; not loss of pressure sensation; not loss of kinesthetic sensation; but loss of pain itself (226).

Disorientation induces confusion, so that a person becomes confused about the site of the pain, about the part of the body involved in the pain, and doesn't know which side is which.

Raise any number of irrelevant and non-pertinent questions *in a most impressive fashion* (e.g., the distraction and confusion technique together). By nonsensical questions you direct the attention away from their fixed and rigid beliefs about not resolving some problems as you ask when they want to resolve them.

Shock and surprise depotentiates rigid beliefs. Observe a person very very carefully, then use words which you know will shock them. Example: the shocking set-up in your office, "You won't like the treatment, but it will work." Surprise techniques break rigid, fixed patterns forcing the person to reorient themselves and put them together in new way.

Subtly let an idea ferment in someone's mind for a whole week. Get them in a state of preparation to receive something she believes will cure her, but will be unpleasant. Sometimes you have to rob a person of their safe phraseology. At other times be gentle and courteous, and at other times insult them (p. 212).

By recognizing the person's orientation, you can disorient. Pace by first getting the person to notice his pain or tension. Then narrow his attention down to specific areas of pain, to the arm exclusively. Then he knows you are not discounting his pain. Call attention to what his arm used to feel like when it felt ease and comfort.

To a little girl with a cut on her knee, Erickson said, "It hurts awful there." She then sensed that he really understood her. "Now we can go to work and stop that hurt." He was narrowing the girl's reality orientation down to an inch-long scratch. By acknowledging the symptomatology and not discrediting it, he knows you understand what is real for him.

As you do, catch the "listening moments" when the person becomes able to listen. There's a right time to speak. "And it hurts just terribly, doesn't it Robert?" He knew I was talking sense. "And it will keep right on hurting." That's what he feared. "Maybe the pain will go away in a minute or two" (ray of hope), "but I don't know, is that good, red, strong blood?" (Distraction) (178).

5) Metaphor: Use a Metaphor to presuppose managing pain.

Erickson talked about "calloused" pain nerves to one patient. "I had her intensify the pain in her hips along the course of her sciatic nerve. I asked her to pay full attention to it. I asked her to observe that pain studiously. Then I said, 'Describe the pain in your own words, not in medical terms.' She became so interested in sitting quietly and mentay studying her pain, that she became really

absorbed. This induced a light trance. In one sense she was in a light trance, yet in another sense in a very deep trance.

Erickson often used the metaphor of callousing. "Do you know about callous formations?" "When you form callouses, pain is no longer felt. When you first eat hot Mexican food it burns your mouth, then you get used to it. When you first start working with a shovel in the garden, your hands get blisters. But as the hands get calloused, they aren't so sensitive. With the food, the calloused formation cuts out the pain while the taste buds remain sensitive to the delightful flavors" (p. 112). Just as we have mouth habits (tongue thrusting, teeth grinding) speech habits (stuttering, stammering), eating habits, olfactory habits, gustatory habits, you can have *pain habits.* You can take stimuli and habitually translate them into pain responses. The problem with pain habits is that after long and continued pain in an area, one tend to interpret all sensations there as painful.

The "calloused nerves" metaphor enabled Erickson to build up the idea that one could learn to develop callouses on the nerves and the end organs of nerves so the nerves become accustomed to distresses and the person may stop noticing.

Laboratory #9. INDUCING PAIN CONTROL

1) Induce a light trance state.
2) Then elicit numbness, moving it around in the person's body, or one of the other techniques.

THE HYPNOTIC NATURE & LANGUAGE OF META-STATES

- How does *Meta-States* relate to hypnosis, hypnotic language patterns, and the experience of trance?
- Since *Meta-States* refers to going *up* the higher levels of the mind and trance refers to going *down*, deeper and deeper, into oneself, are they opposites?

Many have noticed and commented on the *hypnotic nature of the meta-stating process* and have wondered about its relationship to hypnosis. Frequently when I first introduce the *Meta-States* model, I like giving people an *experience* of their own meta-states. So I provide a meta-stating induction something like the following around the subject of learning.

> Have you ever experienced that you found so exciting and so thrilling, that learning it didn't seem like learning at all, it was just pure fun and absorption? You know, something like skiing or rollerblading. Some people learn wood working, painting, even reading like that. It's just so much fun.... and I don't know if you can just allow yourself to recall an instance like that... but if you give your brain a chance to *scan through* your history now and identify something like that ... and when you find it, just be there again, fully and completely... seeing, hearing, and feeling it afresh... because when you do, you can begin to *recover the feeling of focused learning.* And as you do, notice just how much you *enjoy and appreciate that experience...* Because as you do, you can *appreciate yourself as a learner*, can you not for the skill of joyful learning. And as you *appreciate yourself*, you can also feel a growing sense of passion or ferociousness increasing about that self-appreciation and about that joyful learning, can you not? And about that ferociousness, you can rise up in your mind to feel a sense of respect for people ... and if you felt a little bit outlandish in your outrageousness about appreciating so fully and completely your total joy of learning... Of course, you could then become *courageous* about the outrageousness of your appreciation of your joyfulness of learning...

The invitation to *meta-state* yourself (and your states) with layer upon layer of additional states—of thoughts, emotions, memories, imaginations, feelings, etc. takes a person *up, up and away*. People "space out." People can only track so far and then they zone out. It's the experience of hypnosis. But how that can be? How can we go *up into trance?* Isn't the direction of trance *down?* Don't we have to float down deeper and deeper into ourselves? The answer? The structuring (patterning) nature of metaphors

- How do you think about and conceptualize the *direction* of trance? In what direction do you go?
- What direction do you send your consciousness, emotions, and awareness in a trance state?
- What *direction* does your language suggest? What *direction* does the "hierarchy of levels" suggest?
- How do you picture "going in" as you develop an inward focus?

The Language of Trance and Non-Trance

Let's revisit the first NLP model, the *Meta-Model* of language as originated by Bandler and Grinder (1975). The Meta-Model provides us a list of *linguistic distinctions* which enable us to identify vagueness in our language use and communications. In doing that, the Meta-Model points out vagueness in expressions and concepts. And as thereby highlights the presence of *unspecified nouns, verbs, references, nominalizations,* etc. it alerts us to the presence of the very kind of language that hypnotizes. That is, the language that forces us to "go inside" and make up our own meanings. The person who uses this model intentionally and artistically, speaks with artistic vagueness to elicit creative meaning making.

The value of the Meta-model for hypnosis is this: it identifies the language that's so ill-formed that we have to "go inside" to fill in the missing pieces. In this, the Meta-Model identifies the natural trance states that we create and experience (usually unknowingly) by our use of *language.* In that way, we then trance out. This illustrates how language (all language) has the power to hypnotize. It also highlights the genius of the Meta-Model, to bring us out of trance! That is, when we know *how* language works its "magic" to entrance, then we are given the secrets also for how to break negative hypnotic trances that undermine our resourcefulness.

What does this mean for those of us who have learned the Meta-Model? It means that *the questioning challenges* built into the Meta-Model itself operates as a de-hypnotizing model. The questions of the Meta-Model empower us to stop hallucinating as it calls to us and invites us to stay in *Uptime* (i.e., sensory awareness). Then, by coming into the now, and truly seeing, hearing, feeling, etc. afresh, we can then obtain enough clean information from the outside so as to make sure that our mental maps are accurate and useful. Then, instead of being hypnotized by what others say and suggest, we can chose the trances that we want, the trances that increase our resourcefulness. This is the heart of the genius of the Meta-Model. (For the 25 year update on the Meta-Model, see *The Secrets of Magic*, Hall, 1998)

The process of evoking *linguistic precision* from a speaker by simply asking questions which compels a speaker to specify referents provides a great way for truly understanding that person's world. It invites the speaker to translate his or her expressions *down* the scale from vague abstraction to more and more see-hear-feel specificity.

We use the Meta-Model for two things. First, we use it to *reduce* the complexity and vagueness of expressions in language. We use it to pull linguistic and semantic constructions apart in order to de-frame them. This becomes especially important if the language forms that someone uses induces *negative* emotional states. Meta-modeling gets a speaker to bring higher logical levels down to the primary level of experience. Secondly, we can use it to do the opposite. We can use the same linguistic distinctions and instead of challenging them, we can play with them to induce constructive trances. When we know how to move *down* the scale of generality, we can also move *up* that scale, can we not?

It is in this sense that we sometimes talk about the "reverse" Meta-Model, or the Milton Model of language. Bandler and Grinder expressed and popularized *the Milton Model* as giving us a way to *go up the scale of abstractions* using language. By intentionally using the Meta-Model distinctions, we develop the art of speaking with *artful vagueness*. And, doing that encourages hallucinations. It encourages us to "go inside" and imagine or hallucinate sights, sounds, sensations, smells, etc. and to enter into that world. That's the structure of hypnosis. "So what?" someone asks.

Going Up as a Direction of Trance

Well, this has lots of ramifications. By moving *up* the scale from specific to general, we can build new generalizations (i.e., beliefs, understandings, paradigms, etc.) that increase our personal resourcefulness. We can create an internal world (our mental maps) that enable us to be much more effective. This allows us to move up into higher and higher levels of abstraction— into more complex conceptual worlds and categories. And in doing that, we can thereby install new and better maps for running our lives.

From this description of how we use the Meta-Model, the ***direction*** of specificity goes *"down,"* while the ***direction*** of trance goes *"up."* These orientations of "up" and "down" relate to a scale, a vertical continuum from small chunk to big chunk. This means that when we start high and move down, we engage in what's known as "deductive" thinking and reasoning. Such takes us down to more precise descriptions, sensory-

based descriptions.

Conversely, when we move up, we engage in "inductive" thinking and reasoning. Such takes us more and more into higher level ideas, concepts, and abstractions. As we do, things tend to become more vague and unspecific as we go *up.* We see these height and depth metaphors used in a very similar way with the Meta-Program of General/ Specific or Global/ Detail.

What does this mean? It suggests that the central NLP metaphor for trance implies *going up,* rather than down. And I say that even though I love to say, as I think most of us with NLP training love to say, "And you can float down deeper and deeper still..." There's just something nice about "floating down," "going down deeper and deeper," etc. Yet, in terms of using the *scale of specificity / abstraction* (i.e., the hierarchical levels), to go into trance involves *"heading for the ozone "*... and *spacing out* with higher and higher levels of abstraction.

Would you like some more evidence for this? Then think about the most *trancy* and *trance-like words* around. What are they? They are the most convoluted expressions we can invent, namely, *nominalizations*.

> "And you can feel this *satisfaction* increasing because you have made this *insightful decision*, have you not, and now, as your *self-esteem* grows so can your *pleasure* in your *relationships,* knowing that you will be *productive,* and will begin to feel more *effective* than you have ever before now..."

There's nothing like a string of nominalizations to trance a person out and send him or her into la-la-land searching for meaning.

Going Up Into Trance...

In *Meta-States Trainings,* we do lots of trance-like processes. In fact, every pattern is a hypnotic pattern to the extent that it invites a person to go *up, up and away,* into the higher realms of the mind, to set higher frames, conceptual states, and the most transcendental core states. When we do this, we access enjoyable and effective higher states of mind. We move *upward* to our frames of reference. Using Transformational Grammar, early NLP talked about "going inside" to activate a TDS (a transderivational search) to your own personal referents. It was viewed as going *down deep inside*.

In Meta-States we have turned that old metaphor upside down. We think about our *reference system* as our *frames of references*... as the higher frames that establish the very structure and form for the way we think. What are we *in reference to?* If we wanted to track the higher levels of the mind, the higher frames that we use, the frames that *set the frame* for our thinking, feeling, remembering, imagining, etc., then it would look like the following:

Figure 1

Meta-Level — Courageous
Outrageous /Outlandish
Appreciation
Joy/ Delight/ Pleasure

Primary Level Learning *About* —— > Something

Above the third level (i.e., "appreciation of joy of learning") most people just trance out. How about you? What happened to you? Tracking such levels of abstractions *about* abstractions invites so much inward focus in us .... as the constructions that we layer on top of other concepts, and the meanings upon these meanings, etc., it all becomes increasingly difficult to track, well, consciously at least. Although if we *just experiences* the words and their referents... we can ... did you not find that?

What does this mean? In terms of using meta-states as an installation process, we work with meta-levels to invite a person to texture the primary state with various higher level frames. As we do this, the higher frame tends to operate as an out-side of conscious awareness structure. In this way, we inevitably use hypnosis. That makes sense when we consider *where* we send our minds when we "go up" the scale from specificity to greater levels of abstraction. *We go inward into our matrix of frames.*

That is, we take our thoughts-and-feelings and then *go meta* to them to apply them to other thoughts-and-feelings. We transcend one level of thinking and feeling and include that level inside of another level. All of this layering or texturing occurs *in the mind*, the mind working at multiple levels of awareness.

Figure 2

Meta-States Higher level T-F as Frames

T-F about previous T-F

Primary State

The Trance-itional Nature of Meta-Levels

If we examine some of the NLP models which inherently contain one or more logical levels, we will see them as hypnotic inductions for running our own brains for greater resourcefulness. This means that every NLP model that addresses meta-level phenomena (like beliefs, understanding, values, decisions, etc.) inevitably invite us to move up the levels to increasingly higher levels. Doing that essentially involves a *hypnotic process.* It does this because it causes us to "turn inward" with "intense concentration." And that, in turn, then effects our neurology at autonomic levels. No wonder that most of NLP involves hypnotic processes. Consider the following NLP patterns in this light. They *both* involve layers *upon* layers of thoughts and feelings (i.e., meta-states) and a hypnotic effect.

1) Running an Ecology Check

When we "run a check on the ecology" of a state or a system, we ask a meta-level question about other states and experiences. We ask:

- Does this state, belief, decision, part, meaning, etc. enhance my life or not?
- Does it create resources or limitations?
- Does it empower or disempower?

When we do this, we move ourselves (conceptually) into a meta-position of where we can evaluate our evaluations. The meta-function moves us upward to *Quality Control* our thinking, feeling, states, brains, etc., as we say in Neuro-Semantics. We thereby construct a frame-of-reference by which we evaluate lower level constructions.

This hypnotic process invites a person to then access another meta-level—the level of the person's values, meanings, and standards. They go inside themselves and become aware of their internal *quality control* world where they compare something with their set of values.

2) The V-K Dissociation Pattern

When we put one of our internal movies up on "a mental screen" in our mind and take a spectator's viewpoint to this B-rated file from our memory banks, we obviously move up a meta-level. This allows us to think *about* the old information with more objectivity and thoughtfulness. It enables us to "think comfortably about painful things." This creates a state-about-a-state, namely the meta-state of *comfort* about pain, or *calm observation* about an old memory.

We go meta one more time when we imagine floating out of our bodies in the theater so that we gently float back and up to the projection booth. From there we feel our hands on the plexiglass window and see the back of our head in the audience of the movie theater watching the old black-and-white flick of that unpleasant movie. This moves us first to the meta-state of "observing our memories," or observing our comfort of observing a painful memory.

And if we do this double-stepping back process *above* our **time-line** then we have just added another meta-level since "time" does not refer to a see-hear-feel referent out there in the world, but to our concept of events "having occurred, occurring, and will occur." See our recent work *Time-Lining*, Bodenhamer & Hall (1997) for a new extension of "time" as a meta-level phenomena that specifies more than a dozen kinds of "time." (See the article on this web site about the Frames that drive the Phobia "cure" pattern.)

3) Time-lines

Since "time" itself represents a Kantian category, and therefore *a conceptual state* (a meta-A_d state), and not a sensory-based one, to have thoughts-and-feelings about "time," about a specific "past" or "future," presupposes a meta-state.

To do so, we have to go meta to our primary state and think about this concept. When we do, we usually use a picture or icon — rather than language. We see a line, a circle, a spiral, a boomerang, etc. Thus, the Time-Lines patterns, wherein we move about different representations about "time" do not have external "reality," but internal.

4) *Reframing*

Typically reframing works as a horizontal shift. "This behavior doesn't mean this (X), it means this (Y)." Your sixteen year old laying on the couch watching TV doesn't mean "He is lazy." It means that "He has developed the ability to really relax."

Imagine the speaker gesturing to the first meaning with his or her right hand out in front and the second meaning with the left hand immediately to the left and on the same plane as the right. When we create a new *frame*-of-reference in this way, we transform the meaning or significance of an event, behavior, or word.

Sometimes when we so reframe, we actually by shift to a higher logical level. Here, if the speaker gestures the first meaning with the right hand, he or she will move the left hand *above* the right hand to indicate a larger frame that **outframes**. There, *above* the current frame, we set a new frame-of-reference (a new context) which then changes the meaning of the lower level events.

> "Yes, at this level he lazes around in front of the TV, seeking to avoid taking on challenges, but that is because [jump to a higher level] he wore himself out in the soccer practice yesterday."

Consequently we have to ask which direction (horizontal and sequential or vertical and meta) did the reframe take us? To find "the frame" of some statements, thoughts, feelings — we have to "go meta" and look at the higher level understandings/beliefs (meanings, presuppositions). There we will find the frame that drives the lower level frame.

Thus, Conversational Reframing Patterns involves such wondrous *word magic* that they have traditionally been called "Sleight of Mouth" Patterns. These do the magic at a meta-level by setting new frames of references while keeping a person's consciousness focused on the primary level of *content.* In *Mind-Lines: Lines For changing Minds* (1997/ 2000 3rd edition), we reformulated these in terms of meta-levels, identified the *seven directions* that we can send consciousness and 20 mind-line patterns that naturally emerge from that.

5) *Six-Step Reframing*

The six-step reframing model describes a meta-stating pattern. We begin with a "part" of ourselves that generates some unwanted behavior. It does this by either *inhibiting* a response that we want to do, or by creating a counter-response that conflicts with it. These responses operate from a meta-level to us inasmuch as we "inhibit or forbid a response" as "feeling wrong to express ourselves assertively." (Figure 3).

We then engage in the process of finding this part's positive intention. In doing this, we again move to a meta-level *about* the meta-level of the part. Naming that "part" identifies the state of thoughts-feelings that drive the lower level behavior. We then ask our creative "part" to speak to the behavior part to discover its high level positive intention state. This describes the process of meta-stating our positive intention state with creativity to generate better choices (creative *about* assertive part).

Figure 3

Meta-Level: P.I. --Protect Creativity "Part"

or State ←

@ ↓ ↑

@↓ ↑

Meta-Level: Some "Part" that runs → Creative "part"

an automatic behavior program

@ ↓

Primary Level: → Thinking-Emoting 1) Behavior that we dislike

Speaking & Behaving → 2) Restraint against

behavior we want to produce

Unconscious at Meta-Levels

Typically, we experience meta-levels as *outside* of conscious awareness. We don't know *what* positive intention we seek to accomplish by the behavior. Yet some part of us runs the behavior trying to accomplish something. It lives and operates in some frame-of-reference.

Below that, at the conscious level, we don't like the part. We don't view it as "trying to accomplish something positive for us." We think it sucks. We wish it would simply go away and leave us alone. At the primary level we feel at war with this facet of ourselves.

Yet as we go meta and explore its positive intention, we discover what it seeks to do of value for us.

Sometimes even that part doesn't even know. So we establish non-verbal "yes" and "no" signals to communicate with it. Then we access another meta-part, that facet within ourselves that comes up with creative alternatives. So we then meta-state our unconscious part *with creativity.* This generates several new behavioral choices.

Next, we future pace the new choices using the "symptoms," and other signals, of our "unconscious mind." This demonstrates how meta-levels *drives and modulates* lower levels and can do so without our primary level mind awareness of it. We finally run an ecology check to activate a floater ecology-check state to make sure that the process works holistically for our welfare.

6) Metaphor

If in using a story or metaphor, we "bring it to bear upon" a state so that it stands in a meta-position to the state, then it operates as a higher logical level expression. In this way we can use stories, metaphors, narratives, non-propositional language, etc. to install meta-level formats. By metaphoring, we literally *carrying over* one idea, thought, representation and put it in a *meta* position to another. This outframes the primary idea. "His argument won't stand up to a thorough examination" outframes talk, thinking, and reasoning with a *war metaphor* (Lakoff and Johnson, 1980).

In *Narrative Therapy* (White and Epston, 1990), the therapist inquires about *the stories* that have formed and in-formed one's thinking and feeling.

> "What stories have you heard or told yourself about yourself, your life, your destiny, others, etc?"
> "Who has storied you?"
> "What kind of stories have you received or installed (tragedies, comedies, mysteries, adventures, etc.)?"

This presupposes that a person has heard a story or a narrative and over time has come to use it as **an over-arching structure** in his or her mind and life. They have used it as a *glue* that holds together the pieces which gives it meaning from that meta-level. We do this very thin in hypnosis. We **outframe** a person's experiences, memories, thinking, and emotions by telling various stories. The stories *set a frame*, so to speak, as well as induce very states — state that we want the person to *experience* and frequently, *states* that we want them to bring to bear and apply to other states.

Summary

In trance work we invite a person to *go inside* and to access new experiences, new ideas, new beliefs, and new frames of references. In doing this, it provides the person an ideal context (a quiet, receptive, open, intensely listening and learning state) in which to set new frames of references that will remap "reality" — internal subjective reality. In doing this, the person not only *goes inward* but also *goes up*— he or she *goes up into higher meta-states and meta-levels of experience.* And at those higher levels they construct new and more useful beliefs and frames of references. There they learn to run their own brains more effectively and productively. Here they learn to outframe. Here they learn to truly take charge of consciousness.

Notes:

> Lakoff and Johnson (1980) describe the basic *orientational* metaphors that seem to so pervasively govern our cognitive reasoning, categorizing, and languaging. In *Metaphors We Live By* they argue persuasively that our *embodied* existence in the gravitional world establishes the basis for such orientational metaphors as up/down, in/out, back/front, the container metaphor, etc.

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META-TRANCE USING TIME-LINES

The NLP Time-Lines were originally pioneered by Richard Bandler and Steve Andreas. From them came the idea of a time-line and many time-line processes for facilitating change and enabling new responses. Now regarding the subjective experience of time, it is a mind-body state. What else could "time" be? It is not something external. It is our *internal sense* and encoding of events that have happened, that are happening and that will happen. So it is a conceptual state—a meta-level state.

The Neuro-Semantics of *Time*

You have *never* walked out of your front door and stumbled over a hunk of "time." You couldn't if you wanted to. "Time" doesn't exist "out there" in the world. To have "time" you have to have a human mind that can reflect onto itself. Now if you object and argue, "I could trip over a grandfather clock, or a sundial." Yes you could. Yet still you would not have tripped over "time," just some devices that allow us to mark and measure the movement of *activities.*

Of course, that's what occurs "out there" in the world— activity. We live in a world of *happenings.* We live in a process universe where things constantly change. At different rates of speed, everything is in a process of change. At the sub-atomic level, the quantum level (a level that our nervous system cannot detect), the world is but a "dance of electrons."

When we *notice* this and begin to compare and measure one set of activities up against another set of activities, we invent the concept of "time." Traditionally, we have used the rotation of the earth ("day" and "night") and the orbit of the earth around the sun (a "year") to establish the standard that we typically use to measure "time." Over the centuries we have refined our "time" measuring devices as we have invented 24 "hours" in a "day" and 60 "minutes" in an hour and 60 "seconds" in a minute, etc. None of this is exactly precise, which is why we had to invent "leap" years, but it has given us a fairly common standard for computing the *relationship* between events.

"How fast can he ran a mile?"
"He can run right at a 4 minute mile."
"How long will it take you to finish that report?"
"I need some of your time, could you spare 15 minutes for me?"
"When can I schedule you in for our next appointment?"

Time seems so *real* and yet it is at best only a human concept and so a *social reality* that we have constructed. Now, as a shared reality that we all participate in and assume, it seems to dominate our lives. We can even develop *a bad relationship to this concept.* Imagine that one! A person can develop negative attitudes, thoughts, and feelings to the *idea* of "time," scheduling, being on time, having time for this or that, etc. Ah, the higher dimensions of the mind, the dimensions of Neuro-Semantics.

People in different cultures, in fact, have and continue to operate from slightly different *concepts* of "time." In the field of NLP, we speak about this using the following distinctions as concepts. From these we have developed numerous patterns.

In Time people or orientation — being able to get lost in "time" by forgetting to notice "time." A primary state experience that "loses one's mind" about time and comes to one's senses and exists so much "in the moment" that "time" vanishes. A great orientation for

love making, "flow" experiences, exercising, watching a movie, going on vacation. A terrible orientation for attending classes at university, keeping appointments, catching trains, etc.

Through Time people or orientation — being able to intuitively know what "time" it is, to sequence and order oneself over the space of "time," to order and sequence activities effectively. This state of mind effectively structures one's sense of "what time it is" in relationship to activities, and cares about "time," and loves (values) being "on time." A great orientation for business, school, military, etc.

Eastern time sequencing—random in "time." Caring more about *what* happens during "time," than the comparison and awareness of "time" itself. *Western time sequencing—sequential in "time."* Caring more about noting and ordering events rather than perhaps the quality of the happenings in that time.

Advanced "Time" Awareness

In *Time Lining: Adventures in Time* (1998) we have identified many different kinds and levels of "time." That extended the classic NLP model of time-lines. Revisiting the work of Edward Hall, Alfred Korzybski, and current theorists on time, Bob Bodenhamer and I extended the NLP idea of "time" to first of all recognize "time" as involving *not* primary state processes, but *meta* or higher levels of awareness. That makes all NLP Time Line processes and patterns *Meta-States*. Here we will focus on "time" as meta-frames. This will lead us to many new patterns, new ways of thinking about "time," new distinctions about the many kinds of time, and more mastery over this central concept in human consciousness. After all, as a meta-class of life, a symbolic class of life, we are the kind of creatures who engage in mental time travel as we move back and forth between our memories of the past, our sense of the present, and our imaginations of the future.

ELICITING YOUR "TIME" LINE

Sometimes the problem we struggle with does not concern anything in today's reality, but something that occurred in "the past." Thus the problem exists about *how we keep* our thoughts and feelings from the past in our current awareness and use it to orient ourselves today.

As we take cognizance of the world via our nervous system with its five central portals, we *input information*. Next we *process* that information with our internal programs. We also go further as we create *abstractions* of those abstractions. Through words and concepts, we start constructing an internal world full of "ideas" that transcend our senses. Immanuel Kant called these *a priori categories* of the mind. Korzybski called them higher-order abstractions. In NLP we call them *non-sensory based symbolic maps*. In everyday parlance, we call them "ideas," "beliefs," "understandings," etc. One of these is *time*. This term refers to what? Since the *coding* of anything determines everything, we need to become aware of how we *represent* this abstract concept.

The Pattern:

1) Identify a referent: *some simple activity you regularly do.*

What do you do on a regular basis that's small, simple and not attached with a lot of emotion?
Menu List: driving to work, brushing your teeth, dressing, etc.
Remember doing this five years ago.
Recall it two years ago, then last week.
Think about doing it this morning

Consider doing it next week, then two years from now, five years from now.

2) Notice how you have encoded your awareness of "time."

How are you aware of this activity?

What do you see, hear, or sense in your body that allows you to distinguish past, present, and future?

With what submodality qualities of it?

Where in space do you locate them? How big or small? What is the size of "today," "a week," "month," "year?"

Notice your pictures or images.

In color or black-and-white	A movie or still picture
3D or flat	Framed or panoramic
Bright or dim	Close or far
In focus or blurred	Location of picture in field of vision

See your younger/older self or looking out from your eyes

3) Step back and identify the overall configuration.

Does your time structure look like a line, a boomerang, a spiral, etc.?

Do you have some metaphor for it: a filing cabinet, a Rolodex, etc.?

Do you have more than one time-line or time-configuration?

How many? For what arenas of life (business, personal, recreational, spiritual, etc.)?

4) Spatial sorting of the "Time" zones.

Where in space do you sort out your memories of the past, your sense of the present, and your imaginations of the future?

How do you tell the difference events of the past, present, and future?

How do you distinguish the "time" zones?

Debriefing about Time Lines:

In time-line processes, *the location* of images and pictures serves as one of the most crucial factors. We typically store our concept of "time" sequentially and linearly.

Color versus black-and-white, frame versus panoramic, etc. are distinctions that do *not* allow us to make variations along a continuum. Yet we need variation to encode a sequence of events so that we can note relationships between events. That's why our brains typically use analogue submodalities for encoding these variations. *Location* is an analogue distinction that permits us to distinguish sequential events—events that occur one after another.

We typically use *size, distance, and location* of pictures and images to represent our concepts of "time." This enables us to store "time" in various places around, behind, before, above, and below us (various locations at varying distances). If we step back to get an image of the overall configuration of this "time" representation, we usually have a line, which will have a shape of some sort. Hence, a "time-line." The coding/structure of "time" enables us to tell the difference between events past, present, or future. It effects our personality in major ways since it affects our sense of cause-effect, order, structure, etc.

Orientation to "time" —

Past	**Present**	**Future**
Memories	Sensory awareness	Possibilities/ plans
Solid/ real	Flexible	Anticipation of what is to come
Fixed, rigid, stuck	Some fixedness	Primarily movement

Limited	Choice	Opportunities/ expansive
Predestination	Responsibility	Visions/ dreams
Consequential T.	Impulsivity thinking	Anticipatory thinking
Already	Now	Then, one of these days
Sense of reality	Sense of today, the now	Sense of hope/ desire

Time Styles

Out of (through) Time	**In Time**	**Atemporal**
Dissociated	Associated ... this moment, now	Timelessness
Out of the body	In/ through the body	Above the body
Sequential	Random, simultaneous, synthetic	Meta position
Values and likes time	Dis-values and dislikes time	Neutral to time
On time; punctual	Frequently late, non-prompt	
Aware of time	Lost in the now, the moment, the memory	

Time-Line Awareness:

1) Identify your time-line/s.

Having elicited your representations for time past, present and future via the metaphor of a "line," now imagine floating above it and looking down upon it.

2) Float back in time along the time-line.

As you do, notice *the You* of your "past."

3) Now go forward in time.

Observing both the events you represent and how you represent those events, remembered or imagined.

4) What Time problems did you notice that you'd like to address?

What events exercise too much importance? What events carry too little impact?
How encoded? Black, color, pits, turns, twists, etc.

5) How might you like to alter your time line?

Identify some of the things you might like to change about the events on your "time" line: shape, configuration, tilt, color, etc.

6) Using the submodalities, change the properties of the situation, i.e. Distance, size, brightness, etc.

EXTERNALIZING THE TIME-LINE KINESTHETICALLY

It is not only possible to internally visualize a time-line, you can *externalize your time-line* and so work with it kinesthetically in actual grace. This is especially valuable since it helps those who do not easily make internal pictures.

Experiences that you store "out" of time can ometimes become represented *as if they continue always to happen in an ongoing manner*. Even though those events occurred and you consider them done and over, you may code (represent) them in such a way as to cue your brain that those events continue with you as your ever present reality. This is a problem if you experiences were traumatic. Coding as continual, and/or even cumulative, keeps the hurt with you in an ongoing fashion. To deal with such representations of previous experiences you must recode them in more neutral and less compelling ways, and then reinsert them into your time-line as a positive resource.

1) *Lay your time-line on the floor.*

Stand up and allow yourself to turn appropriately and to point in the direction of your *past* ...

In which direction does it feel or seem to you that the past lies in? Point to it.

Now point to your *future* ... Now let's mark this out by walking back to last month, last year, five years ago." Walk with the person to his or her past and then future.

2) identify the configuration of the time-line.

Walk through your present, past, and future. Good.

Now step aside from your time-line on the floor and simply notice its configuration, size, etc. As you take this meta-position by stepping aside from the line, just notice how your sense of time feels to you.

3) Identify a behavior that you want to change.

What is an undesired behavior and what kinesthetics are associated with it? As you begin to feel that problematic behavior, when you feel ready, amplify it. You will want to recognize this feeling because you can use it to allow yourself to go back in time to when you first had this feeling." [Anchor the problematic behavior.]

4) Step back in small steps to where you had that same kinesthetic sensation previously.

Use the anchor to assist the person backward in time, noticing and anchoring it again each time it arises. With more small steps, go back even further, "How old do you now feel or sense yourself?"

"Do the kinesthetic sensations diminish or intensify as you take this step backward?"

Invite the person to go all the way back to the point where the kinesthetics first began. At each of the kinesthetic spots have the person identify his/her age. Take another step backward.

5) After moving all the way back to earliest experience of the kinesthetics, invite a meta-position.

I want you to step off the time-line now, to this meta-position.

Where did you first experience those sensations?

When did that occur?

What do you need to go through life and time and to feel different about yourself?

What do you need so that you do not need to re-experience life as you did?

[The specifically index as the old trauma feelings: where, when, as it brings into consciousness facets the person may not be aware of.]

Do you have these resources now? If not, assist the person find references for those resources from others by imagination (construction) or by putting together bits and pieces of history. Access as many resources as the person needs until you get a yes to, "Does this supply all that you need to effectively handle those events?"

6) Anchor resources as they arise and stack then.

From the meta-position anchor the resources and bring the person up to the *present.*

Reframe limiting meanings that emerge. If the person says that some event *made* them a "failure," validate and reframe it as an experience of learning. Assist using NLP patterns for *updating the meanings* using conversational reframes to give new meaning.

> "While you have found this very painful and upsetting (pacing), you can begin to realize that this has also taught you something very important in life to avoid."

7) Viewing the younger self from several positions.

Assist the person to gain new and different information from different perspectives. This typically shakes one out of a limiting tunnel-vision while simultaneously building up a new and more expansive perspective. Gather up needed resources.

When ready, *step back onto the time-line.* Step onto the time-line where the first instance of the undesired behavior occurred.

> I want you to quickly walk up through "time" on your time-line—taking all your resources with you. Do this quickly!"
>
> [As you say this, and they begin to move, fire the resource anchors on their elbow and walk with them as you take them up the line to the present.]

8) Zoom up to the present and stop.

Depending upon the emotional experience of the experiencer, to give the person a moment to process things. Now let all of these learnings and experiences integrate fully into a new sense of yourself, into feeling so much more resourceful.

T*urn around when you feel ready* and face your old past.

> As you look back on your past, notice how things have changed and become different and will continue to become different, now and into the future, providing you new ways of thinking and feeling about it. [Wait ... to let that perspective integrate.]

9) Facing the future with a new hope.

Now turn around to face your future in a new and empowering way. As you now look at your future, notice how the future too has become different, how it has become brighter and more

hopeful, and you can wonder just how much brighter it will become... What changes do you now notice in your time-line itself? How will this assist you as you move into your future?

10) Take another meta-position.

Step aside from the TL again or from the end of it and look at your present and future from an "out of time" perspective. Repeat this from one or two other perspectives.

What effect does this have on you?

What else does this allow you to learn that you can use in a positive way?

From the end of the future time-line, offer this perspective: As you look back over your lifetime and as you notice the things you could do after that date that was *the present,* when you did that exercise, what would have enabled you to have developed even more fully so that you would have become even more resourceful in your future, now?

11) Reorient to the present.

End the process by bring the person back to the present using general process instructions.

"And now you can take one step forward into your new future ...."

CHANGING OR EXPANDING YOUR TIME-LINE

Would you like to change your time-line or lines? Since our time-lines simply exist in our mind-body as **a coding of the concept**, the process of changing these internal representations of "time" can occur relatively simple. *But...* a warning, when you change your time-line, you may initially experience disorientation, even feel dizzy, "strange," "weird," etc.

Changing a *Through Time* Orientation:

1) Float up above your time-line.

From there straighten your line so it runs left to right. Then, rotate your time-line ninety degrees (or rotate yourself ninety degrees)

2) Then drop down into your time-line.

Do so with the realization and feeling that you now have your "past" behind you. And as you let your represent your "past" as behind your head, you can open your eyes to see the "present" directly in front of your face while the future seems at arms length or further in front of your face. Take a moment with this... How does it feel?

Changing an In *Time* Orientation:

1) Float up above "time."

Straighten your time-line and then rotate your line ninety degrees (or rotate your body ninety degrees).

2) Drop *behind* your time-line.

Do so that everything lies directly in front of you. Make the images about six inches to one foot square and place "past" images an arms length to your left (if right handed). Notice that your "future" has moved to the other side. The present goes directly in front of your face about a foot out. Imagine the tops of all three images to stand at eye level. You have now taken on the codings of an ideal *Through Time* person. Take a moment with this... How does this feel?

Some people experience profound changes as they do this exercise. Others experience few changes. A few people will lack the ability to do this on their own and will need assistance from someone trained in working with time-line processes. You may wish to leave your time-line in its opposite position for awhile just to experiment with it. But avoid driving when you first try on a different time-line. When you feel ready to put your time-line codings back, float up again and reverse the adjustments you made.

CHANGE PERSONAL HISTORY
USING META-STATES

The following is a Meta-State adaptation of a NLP pattern.

1) Identify the problem event.

Think about a time and place in your history that troubles you. How does it trouble you? What problem does it create for you? When you step into that memory, what emotion arises? What meanings? Now step out of that problem state.

2) Take an observer's viewpoint of that experience.

Float above your time-line and go back to the problem event and observe it as a witness to it. From this meta-position, see that *younger* you going through that event.q

3) Gather learnings about the event from the observer position.

This allows you to move into another meta-state about the primary— learning about the event. "What resources did that younger you need?" "What resources did the others in the situation need?" Identify the resources needed that would have changed it.

4) Return to the present and fully access the resources.

From the position of the here-and-now, access and anchor each and every needed resources. Amplify these and then test your anchors for the resources.

5) From the observer meta-position, transfer the resources.

When you have returned to the past event, give that younger you each resource as a gift from your present self. Then let the event play out with the resources. Imagine the younger you now acting, thinking, feeling, etc. in a transformed way. From this position, you can also give the others in the movie the resources that they needed.

6) Come forward through your history with the added resources.

Step into the movie and become that younger you for the moment, and then imagine yourself moving up through your time-line experiencing the resources so that as you move through each subsequent year of life, the resources transforms your history and enriches your life. Let the resources transform yourself and the others.

7) Return to the present and run an ecology check.

Does this new edition of your memory provide you a sense of closure? Does it encode better learnings and responses? Does it enhance your life? Would you like to live with this new edition? Does it provide you a more useable map for navigating life?

8) Future pace.

Look out into your future from the perspective of having made

META-STATING NEW DECISIONS IN "TIME"
Time-Lining the Decision Destroyer Pattern

Design: To use the concept (a meta-level) of time (past, present, future) to serving our empowerment and effectiveness. To undo false, unuseful, and toxic mappings from past events that you no longer need to drag with you and use to torture yourself (or others!). A decision map created at some previous time does *not* have to be treated as unchangeable. You can re-code an old decision and update it.

The Pattern:

1) Identify your Time-Line.

Think of some simple activity that you did this morning, then think about it last week, last year, 2 years ago, 5 years ago ... next week, next month, next year, 2 years from now, 5 years from now.

— Where do you locate these memories and imagination?

— What kind of a configuration do you have these in: a line, circle, drawer, roll-a-dex, etc.**?**

— Differences in Pictures, Sounds, Feelings?

2) Float above your sense of "time" and draw a Time-Line.

Now float back to a specific memory, then float forward through now to a time in the future.

3) Identify a decision, belief, experience, etc. in your history ("past") in which you experience some hurtful, ugly things and made some very unuseful maps from.

— A limiting Decision

— A limiting Belief

— A limiting Hurt that you can still feel bad about

4) Access, Anchor, and Amplify some Resources.

What state, idea, understanding, belief, decision, etc. given you have the resources to make a better decision—a decision that would then totally have transformed that old experience?

5) Float up and then back on your Time-Line to 15 minutes before the Event.

Anticipate that in a minute, when you float back down into your Time-Line, 15 minutes prior to the old experience and look into your future, you will *not* see the old stuff — because it has not happened yet. And now you can fully and completely re-access the resources that you want to experience as you *live through the experience* ... and as you do, that new you in history will use the resources that will totally transform everything.

Float down ... with the resource ... and bring it through the experience and up to the present.

6) Future pace and Check ecology.

FINISHING UNFINISHED BUSINESS

The following pattern offers a process for assisting a person to catch up in their psychic development after he or she has cleaned up old traumatic memories, limiting beliefs, and/or dis-empowering beliefs.

Eric Erickson's Developmental Model *of the Psycho-Social Stages:*

1) Trust / Mistrust of others who respond to and care for our needs
2) Autonomy / Shame and Doubt: Functioning as self-sufficient & exploring
3) Initiative / Guilt: Exploring and negotiating boundaries
4) Industry / Inferiority: Learning to become competent, productive in mastering skills
5) Identity / Role confusion: Establishing a sense of self
6) Intimacy / Isolation: Dealing with companionship, love, friendships
7) Generativity / Stagnation: a meaningful contribution
8) Integrity/Despair: Making sense of life.

1) Adopt a commitment to reality.

Having cleared up the hurts of the past, and having used your new understandings and "ego strength" to face those past hurts from your strengths, you have begun to "make yourself a friend to reality" rather than an enemy. Those days of feeling and thinking in an antagonistic way to reality have ended. The skill of "going meta" to the experiences that that younger you had "in" time by *floating above on your time-line* has given you the skill to look at and accept the disliked, obnoxious, dysfunction, etc. *without taking it personal.* What a skill! And you can congratulate yourself for learning to *accept* without confusing it with approving, validating, or endorsing what existed. You can accept what exists--what existed--*and* dislike it *and* realize fully it only existed as an event, an experience, a set of behaviors--and that **you** are *as so much more* than those experiences.

This skill signifies the adult *recognition of reality as a dispassionate fact.* How different from the way you thought-and-felt as children! Then you took events **personal**, you thought in ego-centric ways, you introjected the hurtful behaviors of others, and you built disempowering beliefs about yourself. Now you have learned to do that *no more.*

2) Access a state of adult acceptance.

Think about a time or situation where you accepted something that you did *not* like. Pick something simple to practice identifying these representations: cleaning the bathroom and toilet, doing dishes, preparing your tax return, etc. How do you, representationally, construct this *acceptance of disliked activity*? What beliefs and values support this state. When you have it fully and resourcefully, anchor it.

3) Access a friendship to reality state.

Maturing, developing, and becoming fully human necessitates a *commitment to what actually exists*, in the place of wishful thinking, magical thinking, and regretful thinking ("oh, if only...!"). Access a time when you positively felt that kind of orientation getting your IR,

submodalities and supporting beliefs and anchor it.

4) Access the state of "finishing business" state.

Identify the state of "finishing something." What project, task, relationship, etc. have you engaged in, invested yourself in, and then brought to a completion and released so that you let it go positively completely and thoroughly. You took the resources of that experienced and moved on to the next step? Think about a grade in school that you finished, or a particular subject or skill that you learned. How did you complete that business with your instructor, coach, friends?

In accessing this resource state of "having positively brought something to closure" notice all of the internal representation and supporting beliefs that made this an enhancing life experience for you. You "came to terms" with the time-limited nature of the subject. You began something, and then you completed it. Anchor this feeling of closure.

5) Finish the "unfinished business" in your mind-emotions.

As you now float above your current time-line, where you live and act and feel and think today... looking down upon it and noticing how it moves back into the past, allow yourself to notice what developmental tasks (of the Erickson list, p. 78) that you did not complete--trust, autonomy, identity, etc. Create a mental movie of what each stage looks like, sounds like, then step in and experience so you know what it feels like.

From *above* your time-line move forward into the future to a time when you can imagine seeing yourself as having finished that task. Now go there. What does finishing that task look like, sound like, feel like? What supporting beliefs, values, and actions go along with it? Fire the "finishing business" and "a friend to reality" anchors as you float down into that time and fully experience it with completeness. And you can enjoy the full development...

6) Use as a swish.

When you have fully captured the feeling and meaning of finishing that old business return to *now* and look into your future at that future you ... noticing the steps and stages that you will *take day by day* as you move more and more into your future... because you can.

THE DROP DOWN THROUGH

The Pattern

1. Find the first event of a Problem

What is the root cause of this problem, the first event which, when disconnected, will cause the problem to disappear? When was the first time you felt this emotion?

Go back to the first event ... float up above your time-line and go back into the past... and as you do you can go back to the event itself and drop down into it."

[Do not associate yourself or another into the event if it has the qualities or character of a trauma; always run the V/K dissociation pattern first to release the negative emotions.]

Elicit a word which corresponds to emotional state.

What is the value or unwanted emotional state? (i.e., anger, fearfulness, timidity, etc.)

2. Preserve the learnings.

As you re-visit that event, notice and describe the emotion/s you now feel? What learnings have you made here that you would want to preserve? What do you need to learn from this event, the learning of which will allow you to let this all go, easily and effortlessly?"

3. Drop-down through.

Quickly allow yourself to drop down through the emotion as you *do a kind of kinesthetic 'free-fall' through it* and do this as quickly as you can... and say aloud the name of the emotion that you find underneath this first experience...

As you just drop down through that emotion . . what do you find underneath it?

4. Continue the Dropping Down Through.

Continue to repeat this process until you have generated a chain of states that run all the way through to a "void", "nothing," an unspeakable stage, etc. and comes out the other side to a positive kinesthetic state.

Do each drop quickly. What do you find underneath that one?

Continue until you float down all the way through and come to the "void," or "nothing," to that unspeakable stage of experience and notice, as you do, how you come out the other side to an experience that has a positive kinesthetic to it. Free-fall another time to a second positive kinesthetic.

5. Amplify and Use the Positive State

When you drop down into a positive state ... perhaps 2 or 3 levels ... amplify it as a resource and apply to the original situation.

What happens to X (the original trigger or situation) when you feel this?

Future pace and solidify.

DROP INTO PURE POTENTIALITY

The Pattern

1) Begin with the concept of "Before "time"

Consider existence *"before 'time.'"* If primary "time" involves the occurrence of events, happenings, activities, rhythms, etc., then before "time" we have no activity, no event, no rhythm--we only have *thought.* Before "time" then only "the quantum" (Overdurf) or "pure potentiality" (Bodenhamer) existed.

We can use the idea of the place of pure potentiality, and the images, feelings, etc. that that generates (the formless void, formless potentiality, etc.) and set them as a frame in our mind. Such meta-stating is conceptual and yet part of how our brains work.

2) *Access the Void.*

Quiet yourself where you won't experience any distractions. Relax comfortably into a nice trance-like state of concentration on *the Void.* See and hear and then feel the formlessness of you *before* your existence— yourself as in the formless void of unlanguaged being. Feel yourself moving back further and further into that time before "time," before any events, any happenings, any actualization...

3) *Fully experience the Void.*

As you enter into this dimension of the unformed, the unarticulated, the unexpressed, the unactualized ... enjoy it... gently, wondering at how old constructions and formats so enmeshed and so compounded now so gently just come apart ... taking things back to a time when they existed as unformed... And you can wonder, really wonder, about all the potentialities that you now see and hear and feel in all of the component parts...

4) *Construct the Possible.*

As you notice all of the building blocks for effective human experiencing and functioning, for creativity, openness, bonding, love, effectiveness, excitement, passion, learning, helping, inventing, contributing, etc. you can begin to allow the process of reconstructing *a more glorious potential You*— a you that you would like to experience in the way you think and feel and speak and behave and relate... and as you gain greater awareness that in this place of pure potentiality you can construct this coming potential Self with all of the component resources ... and you can... now.

5) *Relanguage the Potential*.

Now move forward toward "time" but not into "time" ... yet, but just hesitating as you imagine yourself ready to take a first step into "time" and ready to *language yourself for experiencing resourcefulness*--ready to utter your first Logos... feel all the excitement and anticipation of a new beginning...

6) *Step into "Time" with Your Pure Potentiality*.

And now step into "time" languaging yourself with the words that keep your future open, that empower you for flexibility and learning and creativity ... and as you do then zoom up through the days and years of your life bringing these resources with you as you come...

FAST AND SLOW TIMES
TIME DISTORTION

"There are two hypnotic phenomenon that are my all time favorites, fast and slow time distortion." (Richard Bandler)

O*ur brains* can create two very special kinds of psychological "time"—the sense of "time" moving very fast and the sense of "time" moving very slowly. The fact that chronological and cosmic "time" does not do this, nor do the events of life, at the macro-level, move any quicker or slower, only *we feel that they do* informs us that all of this occurs **inside**. It operates as a psycho-logical function of *representation*.

How does our brain pull this piece of subjectivity off?

What comprises the internal structure of 'fast' and 'slow' time?

The Pattern

1) Identify your time-line.

specify your organization of "time." How do you differentiate between the past and the future?

2) Access states of fast and slow times.

To get a high quality elicitation, identify examples of "times" when "time" seemed to move quickly and slowly. Use your voice and tone to speak in a congruent way. Since we need to get people really into the state so that they can access the critical information, use your tone, tempo and voice effectively as you mention times when you know from your own experience that "time" seemed to crawl (speak in a veerryyy sllooow tonality).

To get a person fully back into the state to get the best elicitation, use quotes, metaphors, stories, etc. to layer a person's internal sense of contexts and context-of-contexts. After all, "time" operates from a meta-level, so fast and slow "time" operate by means of the comparisons we use.

3) Identify the qualities (submodalities) of fast and slow time.

How do you uniquely represent these different experiences?

What submodalities define the difference? Contrast "time" that seems "fast" to when it seems "slow."

Find pleasant instances of slow "time." Typical reference experiences where "time" moved along very slowly *and* pleasurably include: a "just wonderful day" that seemed to last forever. Perhaps the first day of a long awaited vacation when you work all year and then went off on a vacation and during that first day it seemed that "time" just stood still.

In such memories or imaginations, what coding enables you to feel like you have lots of "time" to do things, when "time" moves very slowly when you move very quickly.

Next find a time when "time" zoomed by. The moment came for something and then before you turned around, the event had ended. It passed as if in no time. You have the feeling, "Where did the time go?" "Two hours have passed? No, it can't be!"

4) Juxtapose the "times" to identify specific differences.

Take the two kinds of "time" and compare them. What differences exist between when "time" moves quickly and when it moves slowly? Does the difference lie in the position you use in your mind for the two? Do you have one "time" coded with associated images and the other with dissociated images? Sometimes very unusual aspects will occur in these representations.

"With Time Distortion you may also have a difference between parts of the images. Sometimes the center of the images will be moving quickly, while other parts will be moving slowly, or the side of the images will be moving fast. It's a funny phenomenon. When you're blowing down the freeway going really fast and you pull off into a forty-mile an hour zone, you feel like you're crawling. Do you know what I'm talking about? Whereas if you go from a twenty mile zone into a forty-five you feel like you're going fast."

5) Utilize the time-line if you have any difficulties (optional step):

Regardless of the configuration of the time-line, see the time-line out in front. Turn physically. Stand up, turn, and literally *back up* to the last time you remember experiencing exquisitely slow time.

Back up, associatedly, to an instance of fast time. As they back up to these memories— have them let their future disappear in front of them, and then literally pull the events now around them back up as they saw, hear and felt it. And they can pull those events around them until they come fully into that event. "Take a moment and relive fully this event and enjoy the process while you notice all the distinctions."

Re-orient and elicit.

When you complete this, realign your time-line. Put it back as it was previously, back to regular "time." Having done this, you can do the conscious elicitation to find out their difference between slow "time" and fast "time."

Distill the information.

Do this time elicitation twice, first when you orient the person back in their time-line to get them into state and second when you bring them back. After you bring them all the way back out, get the submodality information distinctions.

6) Anchor both fast and slow "time."

As you do, especially pay attention because this can become tricky. When the person does slow "time" and you discover a difference in one submodality, accentuate it and anchor it. Get an anchor on one knee for fast "time" and another on the other knee for slow "time." This will provide you two very powerful anchors.

7) Identify two experiences to apply Fast/ Slow "Time" to:

First identify an experience that you would like to endow with a greater sense of *more "time."* Think of something that goes by too quickly, something that you would like to last a lot longer. Can you think of something like that? Then identify something that you would like to get over a lot quicker.

8) Install in a trance state:

"Allow yourself to close your eyes and go away to another time and place so that you can begin to make preparations to feel yourself *let go* deeper into a trance than you have before... now, so that you can begin to float back on the wings of time and change. And go way, way back. Because what I want to do, speaking to you as a child, involves beginning to get a little bit younger with each breath, a year at a time... becoming younger and younger. Seeing perhaps a birthday or a pleasant event from each year as you *step back* in your mind, getting a little bit younger, and a little bit younger with each breath.

And as you get younger, you can recapture that childlike ability to learn, really learn, and to experience things. Because when you were very young, a month seemed like forever. And as you get older, months seem to just zip by. And when a child, a month seemed like a long time, and an hour took forever. In fact, five minutes seemed to last an eternity....

Now let your unconscious remember how to feel time as slow and fast and to feel it fully (fire anchors). Because your unconscious remembers how you experimented to find out those distinctions, and it can remember fully... now.

And in a moment when I reach over and touch your knee like this (fire anchor for fast time) you will zip back to an event that went really fast... but because you want it to last a lot longer, when I touch this knee (fire anchor for slow time), you can experience time as moving verryyy slooooowlly. It will almost stand still. And as it does you can relive that event in real time of two minutes, but it will seem like an hour.

SPIRALING RESOURCE EXPERIENCES IN TIME AND COLLAPSING THEM INTO THE NOW

Adapted and developed from one described in *Accessing Your Ferocious Self* (Hall, 1996). It involves imagining a configuration of a spiral or a set of circles.

The Pattern

1) Here and Now.

Imagine yourself in a wide-open space in this moment in time fully associated and fully present to your thoughts-and-feelings. Think back to a number of delightfully resourceful experiences of your past--beginning by thinking of such an experience that occurred last year... And once you see and hear and feel that experience, step back into *this moment in time* and imagine that experience circling around you as the planets move around the sun. Watch it circle around you as if you stood in the middle of a spiral.

2) Let it settle.

Eventually let it settle back to where you first found it— a year ago, and do the same thing with a resourceful memory from two years ago, and again, one from 3 to 5 years ago. As you find, and re-experience each resource let it become another orbiting event as if a planet of resourcefulness moving around you as in a spiral.

3) Imagine fully and completely a delightful resource.

Imagine a resource that you want to experience in the coming year, in the year after that, and then in the time between 3 and 5 years from now. Again, let each experience becoming move around you in a circle as a another rotating planet of resourcefulness moving around.

4) Step into the spiraling resources.

Stepping into the middle of these spiraling, circling resources, just allow yourself to notice them moving around you at different distances, perhaps moving at different speeds, moving into your past, moving into your future. And as you allow them to rotate as a spiral you know that you can breath deeply and fully in the center of all of these colorful, bright, and exciting resources that surround you and you can wonder, really wonder, what will happen, in just a moment when they collapse into you... fully and completely so that you can again experience them fully from within...

(See diagram in *Adventures in Time Lines*)

ACCESSING THE "FLOW" STATE OF THE ETERNAL NOW

When it comes to primary, *"In Time"* experience, *concentration obligates "time" awareness.* When we access an intense focused concentration on some event, object or person, we lose consciousness of "time" as a concept and enter into "the eternal now." We experience primary level *timelessness*. "Time" stops, or "time" ceases to exist as a filter for our ongoing experience.

Experiencing *timelessness* occurs because we cease to have any experience of awareness of other events by which to compare the present moment experience. It ceases because (in terms of foreground/background construction), we have entered so much into the foreground, that perceptually the background has disappeared. For us, as a phenomenon, it no longer exists. Csikszentmihalyi (1990) describes this as *flow.* Flow involves the kind of concentration that frequently arises from deep hypnosis, trance-states, entranced in a movie, a message, prayer, love making, etc.

William Glasser (1967) called this *flow state* a psycho-neurological "positive addiction." He defined it as involving a simple and repetitive task (event, experience) wherein one enjoys it *for itself*. This experience lacks a state of evaluative judgment about it (hence no meta-awareness). It has inherent value and significance for us and involves something that can increase our skill as we practice it, and one that we can eventually do without conscious awareness. Glasser included as examples of such meditation, prayer, running, etc. The distinguishing factor of a *positive* addiction lies in this, it leaves one stronger, more resourceful, relaxed, re-invigorated, more able to get back to the tasks of life in "time." To cultivate your ability of entering into *the eternal now*, the following process describes a lifestyle structure for training yourself in timelessness.

The Pattern

1) Identify a small, simple and enjoyable activity.

Menu List: Hitting a ball, walking, running, reading, sewing, etc.

2) Identify the value.

Run through the reasons and motives in your mind for why and how you *value* the activity *in and of itself*. The more inherent values and meanings that you can ascribe to the activity—the more you frame it as *inherently valuable*. This releases you from any need of going meta and evaluating it. It already has inherent value.

3) *Practice the skill.*

Give yourself to this activity for 30 minutes for three or four times a week. This enables you to enjoy the benefits of ongoing repetition. This also enables you to allow the activity to eventually drop out of conscious awareness and to operate at an unconscious level as a "habit." This usually takes between twenty and forty days.

4) Relax and accept the joy of the activity as you experience it.

DEVELOPING MORE TIME FOR PATIENCE

Patience Now Pattern

Patience and **impatience** are two "time" emotions. They arise from the thoughts-and-feelings we have *about* "time" whether schedule time, psychological time, sacred time, or some other meta-level awareness of "time."

In the state of **patience** we think, represent, believe and therefore feel that we have plenty of time, or enough time whereas in **impatience** we do the opposite. We think-feel that we don't have enough time, that we have a scarcity of "time," that we need to hurry, rush, go quicker, etc.

The Pattern

1) Access your representation of "time"

2) Discover the impatience.

How do you know you think-feel "impatient" about this? What lets you know that you feel "impatience?"

Elicit your strategy for adopting this attitude (this position) toward it. Do so using *the meaning search.*

"What does it mean to me if I don't get all of these things accomplished?"

"What does it mean if I have this and that project demanding a deadline?"

"What does it mean that this activity seems boring?"

The structure of impatience necessarily involves a bringing of a state of necessity or demandingness (from yourself or others) upon some primary state of activity or inactivity. This makes it essential to discover the source of that *demandingness*.

3) Challenge the demandingness.

"Why must I accomplish this by Tuesday? I agree that I would prefer to do so, but why 'must' I?"

"What would happen if I don't get everything done today that I want to get done?"

Expose the *demandingness*. Have you simply been operating from an old impatient program of disliking delay gratification? Have you simply conditioned yourself for low frustration tolerance? Do you actually have no logical reason for the impatience?

4) Move to a meta-position to accept the feelings of impatience.

Go to a meta-level position and fully *accepting* our thoughts-and-feelings of impatience. Do you now feel you can relax comfortably in this higher knowledge and perspective? Bring acceptance, appreciation, calmness, etc. to bear on the impatience, we have meta-stated ourselves into a more resourceful place.

5) Give yourself more "time."

From the position of acceptance-of-impatience, alter your representations of future "time" — seeing more space, more room, more distance all the while re-languaging yourself, "I have plenty of time and refuse to threaten myself in an erroneous way by thinking of 'time' in terms of scarcity." "I will take effective action to do what I can and leave it at that."

LINGUISTIC TIME-LINING

"Narrative is the Guardian of time." (Ricoeur)

1) Discover your story.

What story have you lived in up until now?
Who storied you with that story?
Is it part of your cultural story, racial story, religious story, family story, etc.?
How much of the story did you personally buy or create?
Tell about the theme of your life and listen to your narrative story.
What kind of narrating do you do?
Do you tell a story of victimhood or survival, of failing or winning, of connecting or disconnecting, of being loved or rejected, etc.?

We all tell Stories. And the *Narrative* we tell about "the Events of our Lives" can transform and heal or traumatize and destroy. The Narratives we tell summarize the "days" of our lives. We use various scripts, plots, and themes to frame things. The Narrative, as a linguistic form is not without importance. It anchors a meta-level belief system which can keep us in distress, limit our choices, or create an empowering meta-state.
What is the story of your life in one word? Menu: Failure, Victim, Hero, etc.
Yet when we use a one-word or a short phrase to generalize the meaning of "time" we can create some very limited maps.
In *Narrative Therapy,* White and Epston (1990) describe our lives as *Stories. We live stories* and often we need to "de-story" and re-story our lives. We stop telling ourselves the old story and tell ourselves new stories. Do you need to re-story your narrative?

Since personality arises from our use of "time," and since narrative tends to operate as a large-level linguistic structure that guards "time" and structures "time" (the events we've experienced), we invite you to explore your*sentence stems* and generate 5 to 10 sentence completions. This invites you to generate some of your current and operational linguistic time-lining "programs."

1) *Up until now the story of my life has comprised a story of ..."*
   (Prompters include: a victim, a failure, bad luck, stress, rejection, ease, success, liked by lots of people, etc.)
2) *If I described the plot that the narrative of my life has enacted....*
   (A tragedy, a drama, a soap-operate, the lone ranger, etc.).
3) Say aloud, *Up until now... I have thought, believed, felt, acted....*
   Then fully describe and express what has characterized some facet of how you have responded mentally, conceptually, emotionally, verbally, behaviorally, etc.

2) Step aside from the story for Awareness and Ecology

Evaluate the usefulness, productivity, value, emotional enjoyment, etc. of your Story.
Would you recommend living in that story to anyone else?

How well has this narrative served you? What doesn't work very well or feel very well about that story?
Do you need *a new Narrative*?
Do you feel stuck simply because you do not know of *anything else* that you could possibly say about your experiences than what you have already said?
Go go *above* Time so that you can think *about* the days of your life from there and recode the happenings that occurred *in* time, sometimes prior to "the time" and from "within" the time.
Narrative Time as Linear:

> The episodic dimension of a Narrative draws *Narrative Time* in the direction of a linear representation of "time" by using the linguistic structure of "then, and then..." This describes the simplest form of narrating which results in a Story. It is in this way that we *narrate our lives* by sequencing and punctuating events. Yet in doing so we selectively pick and choose events, delete other events, and punctuate them in various ways so that we create a syntax, a strategy, and a meta-structure of meaning via our narrating.

Linear Time reckoning results in stories. Such narratives function as "the guardian of our time" (Riceour).

> The power of a story: it encodes events in a large level format so that it becomes difficult to change. When we create a narrative or story, we impose a structure on a set of events that enables us to group them together in various ways. It provides rules for eliminating other stories as having any relevance in our mind.

3) Make Up a New Story that would be more Empowering:

Once you have identified the "past" linguistically in this way, then complete the statement,

> *"But from this day on... I will increasingly develop into more of a person who...*

Just for fun, make up a wild and woolly story. Use your pretender to its fullest capacity!
What positive and bright "sparkling moments" have you experienced that has not fit into your dominant story?
What unique outcomes that seem at odds with your problem-saturatured story would you have liked to have grown into your dominant story?
How would that have played out?
What story would you have wished to have lived?
Who do you know that you admire and appreciate?
What story do they tell themselves about their self, others, the world, etc.?

4) Externalize the Old Story to De-frame it:

Narrative Therapy's social constructionism highlights that our Stories are constructions that we have built and *internalized.* We have internalized the messages offered by our culture, family, and friends. We have taken experiences, problems, emotions, etc. and told a story that went, "I am X..." In NLP, Internalizing shows up linguistically as nominalizations and identifications.
Now it's time to **externalize** what we have internalized. We can now tell *externalizing stories* to de-construct the old narrative. This separate person and behavior.

"The Mads have had a long history in sneaking up and tempting me to give way to them."

"Yes, *Misunderstanding* has lured us into treating each other as enemies, but now that we have turned the light on Misunderstanding, we have caught many of its tricks."

Think of a "Problem" that you have experienced frequently (an emotion, behavior, circumstance, linguistic label) and externalize it.

Story: An eight year old boy constantly wetted his bed, his mother introduced him to the counselor as her "little bed wetter" (internalized story of identity). He didn't do it intentionally, it seemed to sneak up on him when he wasn't suspecting it.

"So have you ever stood up to Sneaky Pee and refused to let him get you in trouble?"

Yes, he had stood up to Sneaky Pee.

The counselor engaged in some cheer-leading about that. The boy began taking some pride of his resistance!

"Let's figure out some sneaky ways we can do it to this Sneaky Pee!"

Externalizing empowers us to tell a whole New Story about the events we have come through in "time." It creates a new narrative.

6) Counter-Example the Unstoried to Create a New Narrative

Finding the un-storied Narrative in your life (NLP, *counter-examples*). Find *exceptions*. Find *unique outcomes* that identify "sparkling events" to seed a new narrative. Ask *how questions.* "How did you do that?"

How did you not fall into self-pity, but just kept at it?

How did you resist losing your cool, and listened to your boss anyway?

How did you not discount yourself in that instance?

How did you prevent things from getting even worse with all of that happening?

7) Step into the New Story to Thicken its Plot

Via your imagination, fully and completely step into the Re-Story and experience it fully in all of the sensory systems. Anchor it. Enrich it with details and find audiences to perform it before.

Telling a new story isn't enough. We have to *Thicken the Plot.* To do that use questions about sequences of behaviors to *link the past, present, and future together* and to thereby create a narrative of drama and action. Ask questions that presuppose enhancing responses enables us to assist people in re-narrating their life.

"*How long* have you cared about improving yourself and making a significant contribution? *Have you had any times* when you felt that way? *Why* did you choose to prefer to live your life that way?"

The first question identifies the resource, the second question invites the person to access historical events, the third encourages them to justify, explanation, and build up semantic reasons for it. Such questioning encourages people to "thicken the plot" of their preferred life's plot (Freedman and Combs, 1996).

Future pace: imagine moving out into tomorrow living out that story...

TAKING INTEREST
TO REFRAME "BOREDOM"

Since the movement and rhythm of events lies at the very heart of the life processes—neurologically as well as mentally-emotionally and in terms of the concept of "time," rhythm, beats, intervals, and frequencies play a crucial role in our subjective experiences. This also means *repetition.* Yet when we consider the attitude of mind-and-emotion that most people in Western societies take toward repetition--we can see the cause of a basic "time" maladjustment--we hate waiting, we despise the "same old thing again and again," we over-value the new, the different, variety, etc.

Because underneath rhythm we find *repetition*--sameness, repeating, etc. we find a basic discontent therefore with rhythm in the North European societies. Here we have societies that demand variety and that shun last year's products and fads. This inevitably introduces lots of superficiality and lack of depth into our experiences and that inescapably tends to lead to a dissatisfaction with the old and with the simple things in life. Generally, we prefer the new, improved, updated, never-before seen or heard, the sensational, the greatest, the best, etc.

To so dis-value repetition just because it has occurred before inevitably undermines our ability to find and enjoy the various inherent rhythms in life that allows us to synchronize with reality and experience a quality of depth and satisfaction. Obviously, given this analysis, we need to reframe "boredom," the old, repetition, etc.

The Pattern

1) Identify a repetitive pattern or rhythm toward which you tend to become boredom and uninterested.

What occurs over and over and over again that you tend to hate, dislike, disapprove of, complain about, etc.? Going to work, rising, returning home, doing school work, doing chores, exercising, studying, etc.

2) Move to a meta-position and just begin to acknowledge the rhythmic patterns.

And as you do you can take a new and profound interest in the value of such rhythmic patterns— noticing how the repetition *installs* activities into your neurology at an unconscious level, thus enabling you to experience "unconscious competence." And you can notice how repetition establishes depth and quality--and stability. And how surprised can you allow yourself to feel about these values?

3) Meta-state yourself with other resources.

As you realize the value of such repetitive processes, you can *appreciate,* really appreciate, this ... and *enjoy* it so that you begin to take more interest in such repetitions. This doesn't mean "boredom" or "stagnation," it means power, competence, stability, freedom to move on to other competencies, depth, etc.

THE LOGICAL LEVELS IN "TIME"

(From Chapter 11, Time-Lining)

"Time," as an abstraction, occurs in the mind and so at a meta-level of awareness. "Time" does not occur in *the process world of events, actions, happenings, and movement* and so we have to rise **above** that level to experience this conceptual category.

Gestalting the Meta-State of "Time"

We have noted that "time" does not exist at the primary level, only events, rhythms, activities, etc. exist there. How then do we get to "time?" As we experience events, rhythms, and activities repeatedly we come to know them as **times,** or instances, **of events.** From that awareness we then develop *a "sense" of duration* as a higher-order feeling that results from the summation (or abstraction) of many individual occurrences. This represents one meta-state of "time," namely, "a sense of duration" (an abstraction that compares and relates that configuration of events).

As we talk about these "times" we begin to manipulate this symbol. We begin to number these "times," compare them, sequence them. Then we can say, "Time has elapsed," or, "it took three years to complete the project," or "in another couple of days." Yet what have we actually seen come and go? Not "time?" But events. Our abstraction of these numerous events and representation of their duration, order, sequence, etc. occurs at a higher level of abstraction.

Then we begin to use the verbal shorthand involved in the short nominalization, "time." And that leads us to begin to objectify it as we talk about *it* as if *it* had physical properties as do sensed objects. So we end up languaging ourselves by saying, "time" flows, moves, races, slows down. We then talk about wasting "time," saving it, misusing it, etc. Actually we have reference to times of something occurring somewhere, and not our concept of "time."

"Time" arises then as *a gestalt abstract awareness* that holds past, present, and future together into a structure-as-a-whole configuration, as in a time-line. "Time" emerges from our awareness of events, our sense of duration, our summation of development and growth that occurs "over time," and from our abstraction of "time" as a dimension as in the space-time continuum. When we analyze "time" (as we do other higher level abstractions, beauty, love, happiness) and find the component pieces out of which the structure-as-a-whole emerges, we do not find "time" in any of the pieces. It seems to vanish with analysis.

Meta-Time

"Time" as a mental concept is *a meta-state* itself and operates as a state of awareness *about* another state. At the primary level, "time" does not exist, only "times" —times of events occurring. When we number these elements and compare them with set standards we get what Weinberg (1959) calls "times of times" or "time." We compare our "feeling of an event's duration" with previous memories of the same, then as we think *about* such we create another meta-level awareness of "time." In creating the gestalt sense of "time," we begin with our kinesthetic sensations of rhythm and rhythmic activities. To that we code and

remember these repetitions of cyclical phenomena, and the repetition of occurrences generates a sense of duration--a higher-order feeling.

Primary State: "I feel rushed by what John said about getting this project done."
Meta-State: "I never enough time."
"I hate feeling this time pressure."
Next Level Up: "I feel guilty for these feelings of hatred toward the pressure!"

DISTINGUISHING "TIME" AT DIFFERENT LOGICAL LEVELS

Primary "Times"	***Meta-Level "Time"***
Events, Happenings, Occurrences in the World of Process	Discontinuous & Digital "Time" derived from Conceptions/ Constructions of "Time"
Constant and unending change	
Times Change, Rhythm, Movement	"Time" Concept, Abstraction, Thoughts @
Physical Time	Mental-Emotional/ Psychological Time
Chronos: chronology, clock time, objective time Quantity of time as measured	*Kairos:* Internal subjective time Quality of "Time" as experienced
World of Processes One Dimensional, Unidirectional	World of Representation Multi-Dimensional Time; Can go in many directions
(Events do not go "backward," do not reverse)	Concepts/ Memories/ Imagination can represent events going backward
No Tenses... exists as ongoing existence	Tenses: past, present, future Many narrative configuration

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L. Michael Hall is a psychologist who is continuing the modeling of self-actualization that Abraham Maslow began. Beginning with his work in Cognitive psychology, he discovered the field of NLP and worked for awhile with Richard Bandler, the genius behind the NLP model. Then modeling resilience he discovered the Meta-States model that because the most significant contribution to NLP in the 1990s. That led to the creation of the field of Neuro-Semantics and later, with Bob Bodenhamer, the creation of the *International Society of Neuro-Semantics.* Since the early 1990s, he has modeled leadership, learning, selling, wealth creation, and then coaching. That led to the founding of the Meta-Coach Training System with Michelle Duval. When he began modeling Self-Actualization Psychology for Meta-Coaching, that led to the Self-Actualization Quadrants and other models.

Today Michael is a visionary leader in the field of Neuro-Semantics and Self-Actualization Psychology. He works as an entrepreneur, researcher/modeler, and international trainer. His doctorate is in the Cognitive-Behavioral sciences from Union Institute University. He had a therapy practice in Colorado for fifteen years and then found NLP (1986) and then wrote several books with Richard Bandler. As a prolific writer, Michael has written more than 35 books, many best sellers in the field of NLP and today has written more books about NLP than anyone in the field. Michael first applied NLP to coaching in 1991, but didn't create the beginnings of Neuro-Semantic Coaching until 2001 when together with Michelle Duval co-created Meta-Coaching trainings. In 2003, the Meta-Coach Foundation was create.

Books by L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

In NLP and Neuro-Semantics:
1) *Meta-States: Mastering the Higher Levels of Mind* (1995/ 2000).
2) *Dragon Slaying: Dragons to Princes* (1996 / 2000).
3) *The Spirit of NLP: The Process, Meaning and Criteria for Mastering NLP* (1996).
4) *Languaging: The Linguistics of Psychotherapy* (1996).
5) *Becoming More Ferocious as a Presenter* (1996).
6) *Patterns For Renewing the Mind* (with Bodenhamer, 1997 /2006).
7) *Time-Lining: Advance Time-Line Processes* (with Bodenhamer, 1997).
8) *NLP: Going Meta — Advance Modeling Using Meta-Levels* (1997/2001).
9) *Figuring Out People: Reading People Using Meta-Programs* (with Bodenhamer, 1997, 2005).
10) *SourceBook of Magic, Volume I* (with Belnap, 1997).

11) *Mind-Lines: Lines For Changing Minds* (with Bodenhamer, 1997/ 2005).
12) *Communication Magic* (2001). Originally, *The Secrets of Magic* (1998).
13) *Meta-State Magic: Meta-State Journal* (1997-1999).
14) *When Sub-Modalities Go Meta* (with Bodenhamer, 1999, 2005). Originally entitled, *The Structure of Excellence.*
15) *Instant Relaxation* (with Lederer, 1999).
16) *User's Manual of the Brain: Volume I* (with Bodenhamer, 1999).
17) *The Structure of Personality:* Modeling Personality Using NLP and Neuro-Semantics (with Bodenhamer, Bolstad, and Harmblett, 2001).
18) *The Secrets of Personal Mastery* (2000).
19) *Winning the Inner Game* (2007), originally *Frame Games* (2000).
20) *Games Fit and Slim People Play* (2001).

21) *Games for Mastering Fear* (with Bodenhamer, 2001).
22) *Games Business Experts Play* (2001).
23) *The Matrix Model: Neuro-Semantics and the Construction of Meaning* (2003).
24) *User's Manual of the Brain: Master Practitioner Course, Volume II* (2002).
25) *MovieMind*: *Directing Your Mental Cinemas* (2002).
26) *The Bateson Report* (2002).
27) *Make it So! Closing the Knowing-Doing Gap* (2002).
28) *Source Book of Magic, Volume II, Neuro-Semantic Patterns* (2003).
29) *Propulsion Systems* (2003).
30) *Games Great Lovers Play* (2004).

31) *Coaching Conversation, Meta-Coaching, Volume II* (with Michelle Duval & Robert Dilts 2004, 2010).
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33) *Unleashed: How to Unleash Potentials for Peak Performances* (2007).
34) *Achieving Peak Performance* (2009).
35) *Self-Actualization Psychology* (2008).
36) *Unleashing Leadership* (2009).
37) *The Crucible and the Fires of Change* (2010).
38) *Inside-Out Wealth* (2010).
39) *Benchmarking: The Art of Measuring the Unquantifiable* (2011).
40) *Innovations in NLP: Volume I* (Edited with Shelle Rose Charvet; 2011).
41) *Neuro-Semantics: Actualizing Meaning and Performance* (2011)
42) *Systemic Coaching, Meta-Coaching Volume IX* (2012)
43) *Group and Team Coaching, Meta-Coaching Volume X* (2013)
44) *Executive Coaching: Facilitating Excellence in the C-Suite* (2014, Volume XI).

45) *Political Coaching: Unleashing Self-Actualizing Politicians.* (2015, Volume XII).
46) *Collaborative Leadership,* with Ian McDermott. (2016).
47) *The Field of NLP* with John Seymour and Richard Gray (unfinished).
48) *The Meta-Coaching System* (2015, Volume XIII)
50) *Inside-Out Persuasion* (2017, Volume XV)
51) *Creative Solutions* (2017)
52) *Executive Thinking* (2018)

Volume Books
Books written in weekly installments to the Neuro-Semantic community (Neurons), to the Meta-Coaches egroup (Morpheus), to the Neuro-Semantic Trainers egroup. These are now PDF books on the Neuro-Semantic website.

Neurons began as the Meta-Reflections in 2008 and each year consists of another book. 1) 2008. 2) 2009. 3) 2010. 4) 2011. 5) 2012. 6) 2013. 7) 2014. 8) 2015. 9) 2016. 10) 2017.

Morpheus began as the Meta-Coach Reflections in 2009. 2) 2010. 3) 2011. 4) 2012. 5) 2013. 6) 2014. 7) 2015. 8) 2016. 9) 2017.

Framers is the Trainers' Reflections which began in 2010. 1) 2010. 2) 2011. 3) 2012. 4) 2013. 5) 2014. 6) 2015. 7) 2016. 8) 2017.

Other books:
1) *Emotions: Sometimes I Have Them/ Sometimes They have Me* (1985)
2) *Motivation: How to be a Positive Influence in a Negative World* (1987)
3) *Speak Up, Speak Clear, Speak Kind* (1987)
4) *Millennial Madness* (1992), now *Apocalypse Then, Not Now* (1996).
5) *Over My Dead Body* (1996).

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